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ECONOMIC PUSH

Powered by many engines

The State's growth cannot depend on one city, says Karnataka CM

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CAUSING A FLUTTER
Shelton stuns Alcaraz in exciting contest

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Hormuz tensions flare as Iran, U.S. intensify strikes

U.S. attacks Iranian oil tankers and Tehran responds by targeting at least 20 ships trying to pass through the Strait of Hormuz; Brent crude futures cross \$100 a barrel for first time since July 2024

Stanly Johny

Tensions between the United States and Iran flared again on Tuesday night after U.S. forces struck five Iranian oil tankers in retaliation for what Washington said was Tehran's attack on its warships near the Strait of Hormuz.

Iran responded by firing a barrage of ballistic missiles at the U.S. base in Al-Azraq in Jordan, and targeted at least 20 ships trying to pass through the Strait, according to the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC).

This is the second U.S. strike on Iranian oil tankers in less than a week, which U.S. Central Command (CENTCOM) said was a direct response to Iran's attacks on American



An image released by the U.S. Navy on Wednesday shows a sailor on the flight deck of guided-missile destroyer USS Mason. AFP

warships enforcing a naval blockade on Iranian ports. Following the flare-up, Brent crude futures breached \$100 a barrel on Wednesday, for the first time since July 2024.

On Tuesday night, CENTCOM said in a statement that U.S. forces destroyed five Iranian crude

oil carriers after the IRGC targeted a Navy warship with ballistic missiles twice over the past two days.

"In response to Iran's most recent failed attacks, CENTCOM destroyed the IRGC crude oil carriers M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, and M/T Riesco in the Gulf of Oman

as well as M/T Derya near Kharg Island. American forces directed the crews to abandon ship before the vessels were struck and rendered inoperable," CENTCOM said.

The IRGC said in a statement that its forces continue to exercise full control over the Strait. It also, according to an AFP report, added parts of the Gulf of Oman and the Arabian Sea to a new "prohibited zone", saying that exact coordinates will be announced later. "If a vessel enters that area without coordination, it will be subject to our sanctions," IRGC spokesperson Hossein Mohebi told state television.

CONTINUED ON

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EDITORIAL

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NEARBY



TVK-led alliance gets a name; Vijay to head the front

CHENNAI

The post-poll alliance led by the ruling Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam comprising the Congress, IUML, VCK, and MDMK, has been named the Secular Social Justice Victory Alliance. The alliance was formally given the name at a meeting of its partners in Panaiyur on Wednesday. Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay has been named the chairperson of the alliance. » PAGE 6

METROPLUS » 4 PAGES

T.N. to build new Secretariat complex at Pattinapakkam

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Tamil Nadu government has issued an order giving in-principle approval for initiating the process of constructing a new building complex comprising the Legislative Assembly and Secretariat at Pattinapakkam (Foreshore Estate) in Chennai on an aggregate 25.55 acres of land.

PWD to submit DPR

The State government also directed the Public Works Department (PWD) to submit the Detailed Project Report (DPR), along with estimates, within three months.

On September 3, Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay an-

Seat of power

The massive complex will house Tamil Nadu's Legislative Assembly and the Secretariat

Total land area
25.55 acres

Building area
20 lakh sq.ft.

Estimated cost
₹1,200 crore



nounced in the Assembly the government's plan to construct a new integrated Secretariat complex in Chennai, spread over 20

lakh sq.ft., at an estimated cost of ₹1,200 crore.

CONTINUED ON

» PAGE 6

Centre against English being 'native' language

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Centre told the Supreme Court on Wednesday that it "has an issue" with treating English as an indigenous language, but assured the court that it would move quickly with consultations on granting current Class 6 students a one-time reprieve from a mandatory third-language paper in the Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) Class 10 examination.

Appearing before a Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, Solicitor-General Tushar Mehta, standing in for Additional Solicitor-General Aishwarya Bhati, said a

meeting would be arranged "today or tomorrow" with the officials concerned for a decision on the issue of a reprieve for Class 6 students. When senior advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan sought an order from the court on the issue of English being shifted to the "non-native" or foreign language category, Mr. Mehta said, "We have an issue about that. We would like to make submissions on that."

Meanwhile, the court issued notice to the government on petitions filed by minority schools regarding the implementation of the three-language scheme.

CONTINUED ON
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SC questions notice to student over NEET stir

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Chief Justice of India Surya Kant on Wednesday questioned the show-cause notice by an Executive Magistrate of the Greater Noida Commissionerate to a student of Gautam Buddha University in connection with the NEET-UG protests at Jantar Mantar, despite a clear Supreme Court order barring coercive action against students.

Meanwhile, a social media post by the Deputy Commissioner of Police, Greater Noida, said the notice had already been withdrawn, and the officials involved were facing disciplinary action.

The statement also said

the District Magistrate, Gautam Buddha Nagar, had no role whatsoever in the issue.

Making an oral mentioning on behalf of the student, Akshat Tripathi, senior advocate Biswajit Bhattacharya said the issuance of the notice was "prima facie contempt" of a September 1 order of the top court.

Justice Joyimalya Bagchi pointed out that the notice had been withdrawn the next day of its issuance. But Mr. Bhattacharya said that the contempt of the top court could not be purged by withdrawing the notice.

CONTINUED ON

» PAGE 10

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INBRIEF



Florida university honours
diabetologist V. Mohan

V. Mohan, chairman of Dr. Mohan's Diabetes Specialities Centre and Madras Diabetes Research Foundation, Chennai, was conferred the 'Dr. Herbert and Nicole Wertheim Leadership Award in Healthcare and Medicine' by Florida International University, Miami, U.S. on Tuesday. The award was in recognition of Dr. Mohan's contributions to diabetes research, clinical care, public health, and his leadership in advancing the understanding and management of diabetes.

Woman killed after lorry hits
two-wheeler in Chromepet

Jamuna, 23, was killed after the two-wheeler she was riding pillion on was hit by a lorry near the Ponds flyover on GST Road in Chromepet on Wednesday. Her friend, Sreeja, who drove the motorcycle, sustained minor injuries and is undergoing treatment. Jamuna suffered severe head injuries and died on the spot. The lorry driver, Sathish, 27, was arrested.

After 2-year delay, airport's
plaza to open on Saturday

Passengers will now be able to board cabs opposite the T1 Domestic Terminal, instead of the multilevel car parking; Civil Aviation Minister Kinjarapu Rammohan Naidu will inaugurate it

PORT CALL

Sunitha Sekar
CHENNAI

After passengers can finally heave a sigh of relief as Minister of Civil Aviation Kinjarapu Rammohan Naidu will inaugurate the plaza housing the second cab pick-up point at Chennai airport on September 12.

This means, air passengers who book cabs, can board from opposite the T1 Domestic Terminal, instead of having to travel to the multilevel car parking. It is to be noted that the cab pick-up point at the west wing of the multilevel car parking too will continue as usual.

With the intention of providing a relaxing area for arriving passengers and visitors, Airports Authority of India (AAI) designed a



All set: AAI officials say they had completed a dry run before opening the plaza. The opening was deferred for the past nine months owing to various reasons. B. VELANKANNI RAJ

plaza opposite to the T1 Domestic Terminal. The construction work on the plaza commenced in 2023 and was to be completed in October 2024.

In the meantime, the AAI moved the cab pick-up point from opposite to the T1 Domestic Terminal to the second floor of the west wing of multilevel car parking facility, and this did not go down well with air passengers, who vehemently opposed the move.

After a year's delay in construction, the opening of the plaza, was deferred for the past nine months owing to various reasons.

Officials of AAI said they have completed a dry run before opening the plaza. "Passengers who make bookings through cab aggregators such as Ola, Uber, Rapido, Fast Track, Red Taxi, and Prepaid Taxi will be able to board the cab from the plaza. These cabs, which wait inside the

multilevel car parking, can enter the plaza only if they have confirmed bookings," an official said.

"But, passengers who have to take the other private yellow board vehicles (like companies that send cars for their employees or clients) will continue to board from the west wing of the parking lot only," the official added.

"This is because all the vehicles cannot head to the plaza and it may cause congestion," another official said.

"Also, boarding taxis from the plaza will be most convenient for those arriving at the T1 Domestic Terminal. The rest of them arriving at T2 or T4 may find it more convenient to head to the parking area. But even if they want to come only to plaza to take a taxi, buggy vehicles will be available to drop them off," he added.

'Chennai, a city that
gave me opportunity
to grow and lead'

Chennai, to me, means much more than just a place of dwelling. The bond is beyond explanation. I picture Chennai as a forerunner in many aspects, in education, research, technology, knowledge, mind sports and, not to miss, healthcare par excellence, always with a touch of humanity. Chennai has simple people with big dreams.

Every child back then aspired to study at premier institutions such as IIT-Madras and Madras Medical College. As a nutrition student, I was privileged to learn about the first-ever noon meal scheme, and read the legendary nutrition textbooks of M.S. Swaminathan, and to be part of the "Malnutrition Free Basket" initiative with the man behind the Green Revolution.

I learned about the pioneering work of M. Viswanathan and Sam G. P. Moses in diabetology. My first posting as dietician in Tamil Nadu government service was at the Institute of Diabetology, Rajiv Gandhi Government General Hospital where I learned a



Meenakshi Bajaj, dietician, Tamil Nadu Government Multi Super Speciality Hospital.

lot about nutrition and diabetes. It was there that I was groomed in medical nutrition therapy for diabetes.

I grew up watching *Oliyum* and learning Tamil from *Tamil Karpom* on Doordarshan. I am 'Amritsari' by birth, but 'Chennaiite' by heart.

I will always be grateful to Chennai for giving me more than moon and stars - a childhood filled with memories, an education that gave me a livelihood and a city that gave me opportunities to grow, contribute, and lead.

(As told to Serena Josephine M.)



Advanced robotic system aids knee, hip replacement surgery



The technology has been used for total and partial knee replacement and total hip replacement. S.R. RAGHUNATHAN

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Apollo Hospitals, Greaves Road, has expanded its robotic-assisted orthopaedic programme with the use of an advanced robotic system for knee and hip replacement procedures.

The programme uses Mako SmartRobotics from Stryker, along with three-

dimensional CT imaging and detailed pre-operative planning, to help surgeons assess a patient's anatomy and plan bone preparation and implant positioning before surgery.

The system is designed to provide additional information and control during surgery, while treatment decisions and surgical judgement remain with the

operating surgeon. Arun Kannan, senior orthopaedic robotic surgeon at Apollo Hospitals, Greaves Road, said the experience gained through the procedures had helped the team understand where robotic assistance could add value to joint replacement surgery.

Ilankumaran Kallamoorthy, CEO, Chennai Region, Apollo Hospitals,

said the adoption of advanced technology was part of the hospital's efforts to support clinicians in surgical care.

As part of the milestone, senior orthopaedic robotic surgeons, Arun Kannan, Kornad Kosygan, Kunal Patel, Navaladi Shankar, Vijay Kishore Reddy, and Madhan Thiruvengada delivered keynote addresses.



From the archives: The Tibetan Amdo Drama Troupe presented colourful dance dramas in aid of Tibetan refugees at SIET College Theatre on March 14 and 15,

1962. This photo and more are on display at *The Hindu* Made of Chennai Archival Photo Exhibit as part of Madras Month celebrations. The exhibition will be on at *The Hindu* office till September 14 and is open to the public from 10 a.m. to 6.30 p.m. on all days, except Sundays. To visit, register for free at <https://madeofchennai.thehindu.com/>

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Class XI girl injured as ceiling plaster falls on her at govt. school

The incident occurred during break, when students belonging to her class were outside. The girl had stayed back in class to arrange her books

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A Class XI student sustained a head injury after a portion of a plaster on the ceiling fell on her in a classroom at the Government Higher Secondary School in Melathur, near Tambaram, on Wednesday.

The injured student, identified as Joy Mercy, 15, was admitted to a private hospital, where she received five stitches for the injury.

Inquiry held

The incident occurred during break, when 44 students of the classroom were outside. Joy Mercy had stayed back to arrange her books when a portion of the ceiling suddenly gave way and fell on her, leaving her injured. On receiving information about the incident, the Somangalam police and Education Department officials conducted an inquiry.

In another incident, a



Plaster from the ceiling seen on the benches inside the classroom of the Government Higher Secondary School in Melathur.

portion of the balcony of a 40-year-old building collapsed and fell on the road in Seven Wells in the early hours of Wednesday, damaging an autorickshaw and seven two-wheelers parked nearby.

The building on Kutti Maistry Street, owned by Pattinapakkam resident Thomas, has four shops on the ground floor and four

houses on the first floor.

Following the collapse, police from the Seven Wells station rushed to the spot, cleared the debris and removed the damaged vehicles.

No one was injured in the incident. Based on complaints from the vehicle owners, the police registered a case and launched an investigation.

Timings
CHENNAI

THURSDAY, SEP. 10		
RISE	05:58	SET 18:14
RISE	05:01	SET 17:41
FRIDAY, SEP. 11		
RISE	05:58	SET 18:13
RISE	05:55	SET 18:21
SATURDAY, SEP. 12		
RISE	05:58	SET 18:13
RISE	06:47	SET 19:00

Chennai Weather	max	min
Tiruvallur	38	26
Chennai Airport	37	25
Chennai City	36	24

Chennai Airport Today
36°C The weather will be very warm and uneasy. Night will be comfortable. Spell of light rain and thundershower may occur.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
35°C Morning will be comfortable. Day will be warm. Night also will be comfortable. Spell of moderate rain and thundershower to occur.

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THE HINDU
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Former AIADMK MP sentenced to jail for 2 years in bigamy case

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

A Tiruvallur court has sentenced former AIADMK MP N.S. Jeganathan to two-year imprisonment in a case relating to his second marriage, allegedly conducted without the knowledge of his first wife.

Jeganathan, 69, a resident of Andersonpet in Poonamallee Union of Tiruvallur district, had served as the AIADMK MP from Sriperumbudur in 1977.

He is married to Lalitha, 63, and has two sons, Sadagopan and Madhan, and a daughter, Sujatha. He allegedly married Vanitha, 58, without informing his first wife. The couple have three children.

In 2016, Lalitha lodged a complaint with the Tiruvallur All Women Police Station, alleging that her husband had married Vanitha without her knowledge.

Based on the complaint,

In 1977, Jeganathan served as the AIADMK MP from Sriperumbudur

the All Women Police registered a case against Jeganathan and Vanitha and conducted an investigation.

The case was subsequently heard by the Tiruvallur JM-I court. After the final hearing, Judge Sunil Vinoth sentenced Jeganathan to two years' imprisonment and imposed a fine of ₹10,000.

In case of default of payment of the fine, he would have to undergo imprisonment of an additional one month.

Considering his submission that he intended to appeal against the sentence and seek bail, the court suspended the sentence for 30 days and granted him bail on a ₹10,000 bond.

T.N. to create stem cell registry for transplantation

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Tamil Nadu will soon create a stem cell/bone marrow registry to facilitate bone marrow transplantation. Mostly children with leukemias and conditions such as aplastic anaemia required bone marrow transplantation, Health Minister K.G. Arunraj said on Wednesday.

At present, 50 patients are on the waitlist for bone marrow transplantation,

he said. The Minister said that the demand was high, but donor availability and awareness were less. "We need to create awareness and take it to the people. Like registering for eye and blood donations, we will create a permanent stem cell registry soon. People should come forward to donate," he said, shortly after inaugurating some facilities at the Rajiv Gandhi Government General Hospital (RGGGH).

He added that bone

marrow transplantation was fully covered under the Chief Minister's Comprehensive Health Insurance Scheme. The post-transplantation expenses are also covered under the scheme.

Doctors explained that the public can register in the registry at 36 government medical college hospitals. Their samples will be collected and sent to the Institute of Child Health and Hospital for Children in Chennai for testing.

NalamAI, a WhatsApp Chatbot service, was rolled out for outpatient registration in 22 districts, while a facility to book outpatient appointments was earlier launched on a pilot basis at the Department of Respiratory Medicine at RGGGH. Now, this facility was expanded to all 32 departments of RGGGH.

Dr. Arunraj said that the main difference between a private and a government hospital is that of fixing appointments before visiting

a private facility. In government hospitals, a situation prevails in which patients had to wait for three to four hours to see a doctor. It is to break this system that the service to book appointments was introduced. Walk-ins were also allowed but prior appointments would make it easy, he said. The Minister inaugurated various facilities at a cost of ₹15.73 crore, including through Corporate Social Responsibility contribution.



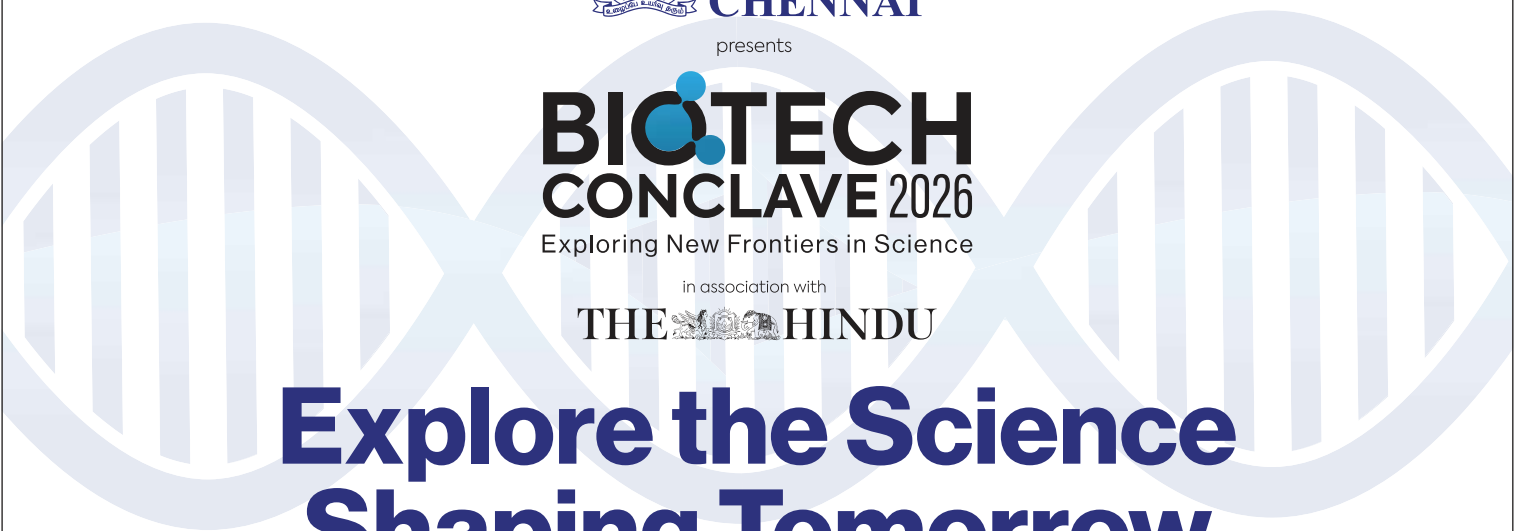
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September 11, 2026 | 10:00 AM Onwards | Chennai



Chief Guest
Dr Suchitra Ella
Co-Founder & Managing Director,
Bharat Biotech,
CII-President Designate



Presided by
Dr G Viswanathan
Founder & Chancellor,
Vellore Institute of Technology
(VIT)

Event Schedule



Inauguration
10:00 AM Onwards



Welcome Address
10:10 AM to 10:15 AM
Suresh Nambath, Editor, The Hindu



Special Address
10:15 AM to 10:20 AM
Dr G V Selvam, Vice-President, VIT



Presidential Address
10:20 AM to 10:30 AM
Dr G Viswanathan, Founder & Chancellor,
Vellore Institute of Technology (VIT)



Inaugural Address
10:30 AM to 10:50 AM
Dr Suchitra Ella, Co-Founder &
Managing Director, Bharat Biotech,
CII-President Designate



**Student Interaction Session
with the Chief Guest**
11:10 AM to 11:45 AM
Dr Suchitra Ella, Co-Founder &
Managing Director, Bharat Biotech,
CII-President Designate



Role of Technology in Biotechnology
11:50 AM to 12:35 PM
Dr Ganapathy, Honorary Distinguished Professor,
IIM Jammu, Distinguished Professor, The Tamil Nadu
Dr. M.G.R. Medical University, Emeritus Professor,
National Academy of Medical Sciences
Mayur Abhaya, Managing Director,
LifeCell International
Dr Shridevi S, Deputy Director, Centre for
Neuroinformatics, VIT Chennai
in conversation with Zubeda Hamid,
Senior Assistant Editor, The Hindu



**VIT Chennai Ecosystem for
Translational Research**
12:40 PM to 12:45 PM
Dr T Thyagarajan, Pro-Vice Chancellor, VIT Chennai



Gene Editing and Precision Medicine
2:00 PM to 2:45 PM
Dr Vinod Scaria, Chief Data Officer, Karkinos Healthcare
Dr Kalpana Gowrishankar, Clinical Geneticist and
Counselor, Apollo Hospitals
Dr G Jayaraman, Dean, School of Bio Sciences and
Technology, VIT Chennai
in conversation with Geetha Srimathi S, Senior Reporter,
The Hindu



India as the Global Biopharma Hub
2:50 PM to 3:35 PM
Dr Maneesh Paul, CEO, Microvioma, Lead Co-Inventor &
Program Director of the Anti-Infective Enmetazobactam,
Orchid Pharma
Dr Vasan Sambandamurthy, Senior Vice-President,
Bugworks Research India Pvt Ltd
Dr M M Balamurali, Professor, Centre for Healthcare
Advancement, Innovation & Research, VIT Chennai
in conversation with Athira Elssa Johnson, Senior Reporter,
The Hindu



Funding Landscape for Biotech Research in India
3:40 PM to 4:15 PM
Ajay Mahipal, Co-Founder and General Partner, HealthKois
in conversation with Serena Josephine M,
Special Correspondent, The Hindu



Biotech Research and Innovation Ecosystem in India
4:20 PM to 4:55 PM
Prof K VijayRaghavan, National Centre for Biological
Sciences, Tata Institute of Fundamental Research
in conversation with Jacob Koshy, Science Editor,
The Hindu



Vote of Thanks
5:00 PM to 5:05 PM
Dr G Jayaraman, Dean, School of Bio Sciences
and Technology, VIT Chennai



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CM YK A CH-CHE

INBRIEF



Hospital forms human chain to mark eye donation fortnight

Dr. Agarwals Eye Hospital organised a human chain to mark the National Eye Donation Fortnight. Doctors and staff from the hospital formed the human chain along with more than 150 members of the public to spread the message of pledging one's eyes and dispelling common myths surrounding eye donation. According to a press release, the event drew attention to the pressing need for corneal transplants in India, where a large number of patients continue to wait for a suitable donor due to limited awareness.

Several fish found dead in Korattur Lake surplus course

Several fish were found dead in Korattur Lake's surplus course on Wednesday. Members of Korattur Aeri Pathukappu Makkal Iyakkam, said fish varieties such as tilapia were found dead. Officials said water released from Korattur Lake through the surplus course was temporarily stopped to facilitate water pipeline works. The fish deaths could have been due to the lack of water in the surplus course.

Underage boy rides bike, mother gets killed in accident

A 17-year-old boy riding a two-wheeler hit another vehicle in Tondiarpet, causing the death of his mother, who was riding pillion, on Vallalar Street on Tuesday night. Mariammal, 40, her son, and the rider of the other two-wheeler, Senthilkumar, 45, were taken to Government Stanley Hospital. Mariammal was declared dead on arrival, while the two injured persons are undergoing treatment. A case has been registered and further probe is under way.

Avadi Corporation developing 12 parks as part of initiative to provide more green spaces

The projects also include creating sponge parks around waterbodies to improve groundwater recharge, mitigate flooding; Corporation also aims to create green spaces in every neighbourhood

ECO WATCH

K. Lakshmi
CHENNAI

In its efforts to enhance green cover, the Avadi Municipal Corporation is developing 12 new parks across the city. The projects also include creating sponge parks and parks around waterbodies, which are aimed at improving rainwater recharge and helping mitigate inundation during monsoon.

The initiative is also expected to create additional green and recreational spaces in every neighbourhood. Avadi Corporation officials said each project was designed based on the specific needs of a locality. Work is in progress to develop the parks at a cost of ₹9.69 crore.

Restoration of Arafath Lake, along with a park at Thirumullaivoyal, is one of the major ongoing projects. Besides works to deepen the lake for increased storage capacity, bund protection works are being carried out to prevent breaches. The ₹2.99 crore project would include a park and facilities like a children's play area, a food court, and an open-air theatre.

Residents of Thirumullaivoyal, however, said sewage pollution into ma-



Significant move: Work in progress to develop the parks at a cost of ₹9.69 crore. Corporation officials said most of the 48 existing parks have been improved with better amenities. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Restoration of Arafath Lake, along with a park in Thirumullaivoyal, is one of the major ongoing projects

For water bodies must be stopped for comprehensive restoration.

Avadi Corporation Commissioner R. Saranya said developing parks around five water bodies would serve as flood-control assets, groundwater recharge structures, and community spaces for people of different age groups. Efforts are under way to protect water bodies from

misuse, she said.

Avadi residents said the parks would provide more public spaces for recreation and community activities. Selvakani. T., a resident of Balaji Nagar, Avadi, said more open sites must be identified to expand green cover. The projects would also aid groundwater recharge and prevent encroachments.

Officials said most of the 48 parks have been repaired and improved with better amenities.

Sports amenities

While sports courts are being provided in areas where youngsters lack playgrounds, fitness equip-

ment will be added for residents seeking spaces for exercise, as well as rainwater storage facilities in areas prone to flooding.

For instance, Nethaji Nagar Park would be developed with a sports complex. Similarly, open sites in places like Jak Nagar and the TNHB area have been taken up for park development.

Sponge parks at Kanakankuttai, Thirumullaivoyal, and Sri Ram Nagar would help reduce water-logging. While some of the projects would be completed in two months, others would be finished within six months, Ms. Saranya added.

CM's body language during Assembly speech not dignified, says Thirumavalavan

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Viduthalai Chiruthaigal Katchi founder and Chidambaram M.P., Thol. Thirumavalavan, on Wednesday, said that Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay's "body language" during his reply to the Demand for Grants in the State Assembly recently, did not constitute a "dignified approach" and was contrary to human dignity.

In a statement, Mr. Thirumavalavan has criticised the Chief Minister's body language, which, he alleged, appeared to mock the looks of DMK president and former Chief Minister M.K. Stalin.

"Under no circumstances is it civilised to belittle or hurt a person's sense of self-respect. Political criticism directed at an individual is one thing; criticism that personally wounds an individual's self-respect is another. An approach that hurts even an ordinary person who does not possess the advantages of education, economic means or authority can never be acceptable," he said.

He also said that the Chief Minister must take greater care in what he says and does as he holds an office of immense dignity and responsibility.

Mr. Thirumavalavan said, "Following the Chief Minister's reply, the DMK, on the next day, requested that certain portions of the Chief Minister's speech be



Thol. Thirumavalavan

The VCK chief said the Chief Minister must take greater care in what he says and does as he holds an office of immense dignity and responsibility

expunged from the Assembly records. During the discussion, the Law Minister (C.T.R. Nirmal Kumar) intervened and made a statement that constituted a historical error. The nature of the state terror unleashed during the MISA (Maintenance of Internal Security Act) period is well known across the country. It is condemnable that a completely erroneous statement was placed on record regarding the DMK president, who was subjected to that brutal repression. We urge the Hon'ble Minister to announce that he is withdrawing the statement."

SOUTH EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE
(1) Tender Notice No.- SNT-R-2026-12
Date: 09.09.2026
Name of work:- Improvement of conference hall of DRM office complex at Raipur.
Tender Value: Rs. 5390190.38, **EMD:** Rs. 107900.00, **Completion period:** 04 (Four) Months. Bidders will be able to submit their original/ revised bids upto **15.00** hours on **01.10.2026** only. Manual offers are not allowed against these tenders. Details are available on our website: www.ireps.gov.in.
Divl. Sig & Tele. Engineer
S.E.C.R., Raipur
PR/S&T/AN/205
South East Central Railway @secrail

COMPREHENSIVE ANNUAL MAINTENANCE CONTRACT AT KATIHAR DIVISION
E-Tender Notice No. KIR-N-2026-K-26 Dated: 07-09-2026. Works tenders through "E" Tendering system for and on behalf of the President of India are invited for the works as detailed below:- **Name of work:** Comprehensive Annual Maintenance Contract of Sigma (Altpro) make Multi Section Digital Axle Counter for Auto section between Aluabari Road-Surja Kamal of Katihar Division. **Tender Value:** ₹2,95,38,572/-. **Earnest Money:** ₹5,90,800/-. **Date & time of closing of tender:** At 15.00 hrs. & opening at 15.30 hrs. on 29-09-2026. The complete information with tender documents of above e-tender will be available upto 15.00 hrs. on 29-09-2026 in the website www.ireps.gov.in.
DRM (S&T), Katihar
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PUNJAB STATE TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED.
Corporate Identity No. U40109PB2010SGC033814 www.pstcl.org
O/o: SE / TS (Design), Telefax: 0175-2207774, E-mail: se-trd@pstcl.org
Short Term Notice Inviting E-Tender
Enquiry No. STQ-5195
Description 15kV NCTs
Qty. 501 Nos. 15kV NCTs
Last Date/Time for Downloading of tender 22.09.2026 up to 11.00AM
Last Date & Time for receipt of tender 22.09.2026 at 11.00AM
Date & Time for Opening of tender 24.09.2026 at 11.00 AM
Detailed NIT/specification may be downloaded from PSTCL e-tendering website <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in>. Corrigendum, if any, will not be published in newspapers. As such the website may be visited regularly for updates.
1078/12/2026-27/14985 Dy. CE/TS (Design), PSTCL, Patiala

CINEMA ARTS EVENTS

MUSIC DANCE DRAMA

Guru Kaaraikkudi Mani's Sruthi Iyasa Kendra
In association with NARADA GANA SABHA Celebrates the 81st Birthday of "Mridangam Legend" Guru Kaaraikkudi Mani, tomorrow Friday, 11th September, at Narada Gana Sabha Main Hall at 5.45 p.m. AWARD FUNCTION "Guru Kaaraikkudi Mani's Award" for Excellence in Percussion to "Chenda Maestro" MAT-TANUR SRI SANKARANKUTTY MARAR. Chief Guest CLEVELAND SRI V.V. SUNDARAM Followed by Carnatic Music Concert by SRI SANDEEP NARAYAN-Vocal, Sri L. Ramakrishnan-Violin, Sri Sumesh Narayanan-Mridangam, Sri S. Krishna-Ghatam. All are welcome.

Naada Inbam, 24992672
10am Ragam and Tanam Veena concert by Rakshitaa Ramesh. 5pm V Bharath Kumar, R Srikrithi, Guru Raghavendra. Today at Ragasudha Hall.

Sri Thyaga Brahma Gana Sabha (Regd.) Vani Mahal. Ph: 28152166
In association with NIPPO INDO NATIONAL LIMITED Dedicated to the memory of Sri P. Obul Reddy and Smt. P. Gnanamba. Today 4.30pm Namasankeerthanam by Thillaisthanam Sisters' Kum.Vardhini & Kum. Varshini. 6.30 pm Vocal Concert by 'The Vadasthir Sisters' Smt. Sriranjani Ramkumar & Smt. Sruthilaya Manikandan, Pudukkottai Sri R. Ambika Prasad (Violin), Sri Ganapathyraman.B (Mrudangam). All are welcome.

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CHITTARANJAN LOCOMOTIVE WORKS CORRIGENDUM
No: - 91260050 dated 05/09/2026. Sub: Change of tender opening date & Description. Ref: (i) COS/CRJ/PUB/c-Tender/19/0162 dtd. 27/06/2026. Tender No:-91260050 for procurement of "3-Phase Asynchronous Traction Motor (with Shaft Mounted Zr-Cu Stamping type Resistance Ring Design of Rotor, Scheme-I) type 6FRA 6068" scheduled to be opened on 14/09/26. Details corrigendum are as below: Sl.No.: Details: From/Existing: To be read as: (1) : Tender Opening date; 05/09/2026; 14/09/2026. (2); Description under Consignee 3-Phase/CRJ and DKAE; Existing entry: 3-Phase Asynchronous Traction Motor (With Shaft Mounted Zr-Cu Stamping Type Resistance Ring Design Of Rotor, Scheme-I) Type 6FRA6068 for WAG-9 LOCOS with out active speed sensor. As per Spec. No-4TMS.096.080, Rev-1, Alt-5 (or Latest), STR No.- CLW/2008/3PHTM/ST R/0001, Rev-1, Alt-2 (or Latest), C&D No.- 5700/004, Drg. No. 0TWD.096.001, Alt-3 or latest. PR7/479 Dy. CMM/P/CLW/CRJ
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TAMIL NADU MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LTD.
(A GOVERNMENT OF TAMIL NADU UNDERTAKING)
No.417, Pantheon Road, Chennai - 600 008. Phone : 044-2819 1890,2819 0259
Website : www.tnmsc.tn.gov.in e-mail : gndrug.tnmsc@tn.gov.in, mngprdrug.tnmsc@tn.gov.in
Online Tenders is invited by the Tender Inviting Authority, Tamilnadu Medical Services Corporation Ltd., Chennai – 600008, for the supply of **Drugs for Rare Diseases** from the Licensed Manufacturers having three years Market Standing and holding Good Manufacturing Practice Certificate (as per revised Schedule-"M") issued by the Drug Control Authority, Direct Importers holding a valid Import License and experienced in the field for a minimum period of three years and Loan Licensees having valid Loan License are also eligible to participate in this tender.
Sl. No. Description e-Tender Reference Tender Floating Period e-Tender Submission Duration Date and time of online opening of Technical Bids
1. Online Tender for the supply of Drugs for Rare Diseases to TNMISC Limited under e-procurement system for one year from the date of acceptance e-022/M/P/DRUG/CH/TNMSC/2026, Dated: 11.09.2026 11.09.2026 at 4.00 PM to 12.10.2026 upto 4.00 PM 21.09.2026 at 10.00 AM to 12.10.2026 upto 4.00 PM 12.10.2026 at 5.00 PM
The tender document can be downloaded and the tender shall be submitted at <https://tenders.gov.in/>. The tender document can also be downloaded at www.tnmsc.tn.gov.in for reference purpose.
DIPR/2807/Tender/2026 Tender Inviting Authority / General Manager (Drugs)

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA - DEPARTMENT OF WATER RESOURCES
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER & BASIN MANAGER,
SUBARNAREKHA & BUDHABALANGA BASIN, AT/PO:- LAXMIPOSI, DIST : MAYURBHANJ
Mail Id :- cebmsbb2019@gmail.com
Government of Odisha - "e" PROCUREMENT NOTICE
Bid Identification No.- 11 /26-27 of CEBM, SBB, Laxmiposi
1. Name of Work CAD & WM Work
2. Total No of Projects 2 Nos.
3. Estimated Cost Varies from Rs.468.30 Lakh to Rs.522.77 Lakh
4. EMD Details can be seen in the DTGN of bid documents of the respected works.
5. Period of Completion Details can be seen in the DTGN of bid documents of the respected works.
6. Class of Contractor "A" Class
7. Date & Time of availability of bid document in the portal 10.09.2026 at 10.00 AM
8. Last date/time for receipt of bid in the portal 30.09.2026 up to 5.00 PM
9. Date of Opening of Bid 01.10.2026 at 11.00 A.M.
10. Name & Address of the O.I.T. Chief Engineer & Basin Manager, O/O the CE&BM, Subarnarekha & Budhabalanga Basin, Laxmiposi, Mayurbhanj
Further details can be seen from the e-Procurement Portal "<https://tendersodisha.gov.in>".
Chief Engineer & Basin Manager,
Subarnarekha & Budhabalanga Basin, Laxmiposi, Mayurbhanj
32001/854/2627 OIPR-32001/32429/1/26-27/0008

बिहार सरकार
कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय
लोक स्वास्थ्य प्रमंडल, गया
केवल ई0 निविदा पद्धति के अनुसार वेबसाईट एवं www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in पर अतिअल्पकालीन ई-निविदा आमंत्रित सूचना संख्या- 03/2026-27/T/W/GAYA
01. विज्ञापन दाता का पदनाम एवं पता : कार्यपालक अभियंता, लोक स्वास्थ्य प्रमंडल, गया
02. निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना एवं निगंत की तिथि : दिनांक 07 / 09 / 2026
03. परिमाण विपन्न बिक्री (हाउस लोड एवं अपलोड कर) की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय : दिनांक-14 / 09 / 2026 से 18 / 09 / 2026 के 3:00 बजे अपा तक (www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)
04. निविदा खोलने(तकनीकी बीड) की तिथि एवं समय : दिनांक-18 / 09 / 2026 के 4:00 बजे अपा।
05. वित्तीय बीड खोलने की तिथि एवं समय : तकनीकी बीड के अनुमोदन के उपरान्त।
06. निविदा वैधता की तिथि : 120 दिन
07. कार्य विवरणी
युग सं0 कार्य का नाम प्राकल्पित राशि अग्रघन की राशि Cost of BOO (non-refundable) payment only online mode, in favour of BSERC Beltron Processing Fee (To be paid online) कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि
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PR. No. 011424 (PHED) 2026-27 कार्यपालक अभियंता लोक स्वास्थ्य प्रमंडल, गया
विस्तृत जानकारी www.state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।
गर्भावस्था की पहली तिमाही में माँ की एच.आई.वी. और सिफलिस की जाँच जरूर करायें।

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PUBLIC NOTICE
I, ANU, wife of Balaji, born on 23rd August 1977 (native district: Chennai) residing at No.68/8B, Thiru Vi Ka Street, Vyasarpadi, Chennai-600039, shall henceforth be known as Mrs.Loganayaki. - Anu
I, CHANCHAL MEHTA Sachin Mehta born on 14.9.1984 residing at AH-233,2nd Street, 8th Main Road, Annanagar, Chennai-600040 shall henceforth be known as Chanchal Mehta.
I, SACHIN MEHTA Laxminarayan Mehta born on 14.9.1984 residing at AH-233, 2nd Street, 8th Main Road, Annanagar, Chennai-600040 shall henceforth be known as Sachin Mehta.
I, Rubert Jebastin Joy J, My Daughter CENNIE JOY, Born on 18/09/2010, Residing at No.14, 5th Cross, United India Colony,Kodambakkam, Chennai- 24 shall henceforth be known as ANNA JOY R
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LOSS OF ORIGINAL DOCUMENT
Under instructions from my client Mrs. Madhavi Baskaran, W/o. Mr. Baskaran, I.A.S. (Retd.), aged about 71 years, residing at No.2, Vembuli Annan Koll 2nd Street, Gowriyakkam, Selayur, Chennai – 600073, notice is hereby given that the Original Sale Deed Document No.925 of 1989, relating to the property being Flat No.D2, First Floor, situated at Old No.30 / New No.77, Krish Apartments, Thambiah Reddy Road, West Mambalam, Chennai – 600033, within the jurisdiction of SRO Thiyagaraya Nagar, Registration District Chennai South, Thiyagaraya Nagar Taluk, Chennai District, has been lost/misplaced. Despite diligent search, the original document could not be traced. Any person having possession of or any claim/interest in the said original document is requested to contact the undersigned within 7 days from the date of publication, failing which the document shall be treated as lost / non-traceable and my client shall proceed accordingly.
P.SAVITHA, ADVOCATE
No.2/82, Raj Ilam, Azhagiri Street, Santoshapuram, Chennai – 600073. Ph: 9566267400
M/s. Lincoln Electric Company (India) Private Limited,
Plot No. 40/1, 2 DTA, Central Avenue Mahindra World City Developers Ltd., - Industrial Park, Anjur Village, Chengalpattu Taluk, Chengalpattu District, Tamil Nadu - 603004
PUBLIC NOTICE
This is to inform the public that State Environmental Impact Assessment Authority (SEIAA), Tamil Nadu has issued Environmental Clearance (EC) certificate to M/s. Lincoln Electric Company (India) Private Limited, Chengalpattu, vide File No: 13195 & EC Identification No: EC26C3806TN5507716N, dated: 05.02.2026 for "Proposed Development of Industrial Buildings" at Chengalpattu District over an extent of 5.75 Ha (14.21 Acres) at Survey No: 92/1, 92/2, 93/2, 94/1, 94/2, 95/1, 95/2, 96/1A, 96/1B, 96/1C, 96/2, 99/1, 99/2, 233, 234/1, 234/2, 235, 236/1, 237/5, 238/1A, 238/1B, 238/1C, 238/1D, 238/1E, 238/2, 238/3, 238/4, 238/5, 238/6, 239, 240/2, 241/2, 241/3A, 241/3B in Lease A, 77/2B, 77/2C, 83/1, 83/2, 84/1, 96/1A, 96/1C, 97, 98, 99/1, 99/2, 100/1, 100/2A, 100/2B, 100/2C, 100/3, 100/4, 100/5, 100/6A, 100/6B, 101/1A, 101/1B, 101/2A, 101/2B, 101/3, 233, 234/1 in Lease B of Anjur Village, Chengalpattu Taluk, Chengalpattu District and Tamil Nadu State.
The Environmental Clearance certificate issued by SEIAA, Tamil Nadu is available on the official website of SEIAA, TN (PARIVESH) and clearance is also available with the Tamil Nadu Pollution Control Board (TN-PCB), Chennai.
For M/s. Lincoln Electric Company (India) Private Limited



GOVERNMENT OF TAMILNADU - HINDU RELIGIOUS AND CHARITABLE ENDOWMENTS DEPARTMENT
Arulmigu Kasiviswanathaswamy Temple, Kumbakonam Town & Taluk, Thanjavur District.
e-TENDER NOTICE No.01/2026 Dated:10.09.2026 - FORM OF CONTRACT : ITEM WISE RATE
Online e-Tender called for by the Executive Officer, Arulmigu Kasiviswanathaswamy Temple, Kumbakonam Town & Taluk, Thanjavur District from the Registered with current Government Contractor & HRCE approved Shapathy/Sirpi for the following works.

S. No.	Name of Work	Approximate value of work Rs. (including GST @ 18%)	Amount of E.M.D (in Rupees)	Period of Completion	Eligible Class of Contractor	EMD to be remitted in favour of
1.	Repair and Renovation of Arulmigu Kasiviswanathaswamy Temple and Sodasamagalingam, Kumbakonam Town & Taluk, Thanjavur District.	2,78,31,473/-	1,49,200/-	12 Months	Registered in Tamil Nadu Government Contractor & HRCE approved Shapathy/Sirpi	Executive Officer, Arulmigu Kasiviswanathaswamy Temple, Kumbakonam Town & Taluk, Thanjavur District. (online only)

1. For Tender documents and Any other Clarification Visit to <https://tntenders.gov.in>
2. Tender documents available at Website: From 10.09.2026 5.45 PM to 29.09.2026 up to 5.45 PM (as per server system clock)
3. Last Date and Time for submission of tender documents through online: 29.09.2026 up to 10.00 AM (as per server system clock)
4. Date and Time of opening of the e-tender: 29.09.2026 11.00 AM (as per server system clock) onwards.

S. Aswini B.E. LLB
Fit person/Asst. Commissioner

DIPR / 2779 / TENDER / 2026

K. Sundararajan M.Sc.,
Executive Officer



Uttar Pradesh State Institute of Forensic Science, Lucknow
Aurawan, Daroga Kheda,
P.O. Banthra, Lucknow -226401
(Expression of Interest)



UPSIFS, Lucknow (Established in 2021) functioning under the aegis of the Home Department, Govt. of U.P. & affiliated with the National Forensic Science University, Gandhinagar, Gujarat. UPSIFS, Lucknow is inviting Expression of Interest (EOI) for Empanelment of Vendor of Book/E-Book/Journal and other Print material for Library of the institute. The details of EOI are available on institute website www.upsifs.ac.in The last date for application is 20.09.2026.

Sd/-
Assistant Registrar
(Academic)
UPSIFS, Lucknow

UPID Ro.: 255726
R.O. Dt: 08/09/2026
Website: www.up.gov.in

कार्यालय प्रधानाचार्य, बी0आर0डी0 मेडिकल कालेज गोरखपुर।
Website:- <https://brdmc.ac.in> E-Mail ID:-brdmcgkp1969@gmail.com
संख्या 64 / बीआरजी/एमसी-2026/नेचि दिनांक 05/09/2026

सार्वजनिक सूचना

विषय- संस्था में पैथोलोजी विभाग के लिए Xmatrix Elite Diagnostics System Bearing catalog number AS4040B USA (Immuno Histochemistry (IHC), Fluorescence in situ hybridization (FISH), and Multiplex Applications (IHC/ISH) as well as Micro-RNA ISH) से सज्जित जॉबों में प्रयोग होने वाले किट्स का क्रय, प्रोपराइटी आधार पर किस्म जानने के सम्बन्ध में आपत्तियां / टिप्पणियां आमंत्रित की जाती है।

राजकीय मेडिकल कालेज गोरखपुर के पैथोलोजी विभाग हेतु प्रोपराइटी के आधार पर रिजेन्ट्स/किट्स की कीमत का प्रस्ताव Bio Genex Laboratories Inc. USA. के अधिकृत डीलर मेडर्स Dr. Meditech Surgicals & Diagnostics (India) Pvt. Ltd. Padri Bazar Gorakhpur-273014 द्वारा प्रस्तुत किया गया है। जिसकी एक प्रति सूचना हेतु संलग्न की गयी है. यदि किसी निर्माता/व्यक्ति को इन वस्तुओं के प्रोपराइटी खर्चा पर कोई आपत्ति या टिप्पणी हो तो वह सात दिनों के भीतर प्रधानाचार्य बी0आर0डी0 मेडिकल कालेज गोरखपुर-273013 के कार्यालय अथवा ई-मेल आई0डी0-brdmcgkp1969@gmail.com के माध्यम से निर्यात तिथि तक आपत्तियां या टिप्पणियां प्रस्तुत कर सकते हैं। यदि इस नोटिस की अपलोडिंग के सात दिनों के भीतर कोई प्रतिनिधित्व प्राप्त नहीं होता है तो प्रस्तावित खरीद को लागू नियमों के अनुसार में प्रक्रिया में लाया जाएगा। प्रोपराइटी सम्बन्धित प्रश्न कालेज वेबसाइट <https://brdmc.ac.in> पर अवलोकनार्थ उपलब्ध है।

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गोरखपुर।

UPID RO: 255725 Dt:08/09/2026
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ADVERTISEMENT No. SAC:02:2026,
dated 10-09-2026

SAC (ISRO) invites on-line applications for the temporary positions of Junior Research Fellows, Research Associate and Project Scientist-I in various subject fields. Interested candidates possessing required qualification may visit SAC website <https://www.sac.gov.in> or <https://careers.sac.gov.in> for detailed advertisement and online application. Online recruitment portal will remain open from 1000 hours of 10.09.2026 to 1700 hours of 30.09.2026 for online registration and submission of application.

CBC 49107/11/0017/2627

APPOINTMENT

TNPPL TAMILNADU NEWSPRINT AND PAPERS LIMITED

TNPPL, a Government of Tamil Nadu Enterprise and a reputed Paper, Paper Board, Tissue and Cement Manufacturing Company having its Corporate Office at Chennai and manufacturing facilities at Karur District (Unit-I) & Trichy District (Unit-II) with a turnover of more than ₹4500 Crores, intends to hire the following personnel:-

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2.	Chief Manager (Marketing)	1	GT	Ernakulam
3.	Manager (Marketing) / Deputy Manager (Marketing)	1	GT	Mumbai
4.	Deputy Manager (Marketing) / Assistant Manager (Marketing)	1	GT	Ahmedabad
SECRETARIAL:-				
5.	Assistant Manager (Secretarial)	1	GT	Corporate Office

For details relating to age, qualification, experience, etc., please visit TNPPL's website: www.tnppl.com/careers. Bio-data format is available in our website. Candidates who conform to the job requirements as given in the website may apply in the prescribed format by post in strict confidence superscribing the name of the post (both in Bio-data and top of the Envelope) within 15 days from the date of release of this advertisement to the below mentioned address, giving full details of age, qualification with year of passing, experience, community, salary drawn and position being held along with copies of testimonials towards proof for the same. Bio-data form with insufficient documentary proof will be summarily rejected.

CHIEF GENERAL MANAGER (HR)
TAMIL NADU NEWSPRINT AND PAPERS LIMITED
NO.67, ANNA SALAI, GUINDY, CHENNAI – 600 032, TAMIL NADU
www.tnppl.com

DIPR/779/DISPLAY/2026 TNPPL - Protecting the environment, building the society.

GOVERNMENT OF TAMIL NADU
DEPARTMENT OF HINDU RELIGIOUS & CHARITABLE ENDOWMENT
ARULMIGU RAMASWAMI TEMPLE, KUMBAKONAM TOWN & TALUK, THANJAVUR DISTRICT
e-TENDER NOTICE No: 1/2026/Date:10.09.2026 (Lumpsum Contract – Price tender- Single cover system)

The Executive Officer Of Arulmigu Ramaswami Temple, Kumbakonam Town & Taluk, Thanjavur District Is Invited e-Procurement By e-Tender Form The Eligible Contractors For Following Works. Other Important Details And Any Correction Of BOQ, Tender Documents and Revision If any Obtained official website <https://tntenders.gov.in> or Notice Board of Temple office.

Name Of the Work	Tender Value With GST 18%	EMD (Through Online Payment - https://tntenders.gov.in)	Period of Work	Eligible Of Contractor
Repair And Renovation Work Of Arulmigu Ramaswami Temple, Kumbakonam Town & Taluk, Thanjavur District.	Rs. 1,64,33,241/-	Rs.92,170/-	12 Months	Shapathi / Sculptor Registered By Thiruchore Department With Live Certificate Of The Contractor Registered In Government Of Tamil Nadu / Organization Of Government Of Tamil Nadu With Live Certificate (Without Shapathi / Sculptor Contractors Shall Be Submitted Hrce Registered Shapathi / Sculptor Opinion Certificate)

1.e-Tender BOQ And Tender Documents Can be Available from : 10.09.2026, 5.45 pm to 29.09.2026 At 5.45 pm. 2. e-Tender Filled BOQ and Tender Documents Will be Uploaded (Last Date) : On 30.09.2026 Still Now 11.00 am. 3. e-Tender Opening Date and Time On 30.09.2026 at 1.00 pm. 4.EMD Amount Shall be Remitted Through Online <https://tntenders.gov.in>. 5.Terms and Conditions:According to BOQ and Tender Conditions.
R.Sivendharaja, Executive Officer
Arulmigu Ramaswami Temple,Kumbakonam Town & Taluk, Thanjavur District.
DIPR/2777/TENDER/2026

Tamil Nadu Power Distribution Corporation Ltd.
Notice Inviting Tenders (E-Tendering Process)

Specification No.	Tender Inviting Authority	Name of the Work
TS(S)133	CE / D / Kanchipuram	Sale of Scraps available at Central Stores CEDC South I Chennai

For details of works / Procurement / Due date of submission / Opening, viewing and downloading of e-tenders, please visit the websites www.tnpdcl.org, www.tenders.tn.gov.in, www.tntenders.gov.in
DIPR/2821/Tender/2026

TAMIL NADU CIVIL SUPPLIES CORPORATION
HEAD OFFICE :
CMRL ADMIN BUILDING, POONAMALEE HIGH ROAD,
KOYAMBEDU, CHENNAI - 600 107.

Re Short e-tender No. : BS4/016600/2026/TNCSC/26-27 Dated : 07.09.2026

RE SHORT E-TENDER NOTICE

Online Re short e-tender is invited for the “ PURCHASE OF 7,250 Bales of 5 PLY JUTE TWINE (WEIGHING 185 Kg .NETT PER BALE as per specifications.

Complete Re Short e-tender document can be viewed and downloaded through <https://tntenders.gov.in/nicgep/app>

The bidders have to participate online bidding only with Digital Signature Certificate (DSC) of Class-II or Class-III.

Last Date and Time for Online Submission : 16.09.2026 up to 11.00 A.M

DIPR/2798/Tender/2026 Managing Director.

The photograph shows M. S. Viswanathan and T. K. Ramamoorthy being honoured in 1963. What title was bestowed on the duo?

Answer to yesterday's Photo quiz:

Justice and rehabilitation for Sri Lankan Tamils

Yesterday's winners:

1. Poongodhai D
2. Sindhura Kannappan
3. Naasima S

Scan QR code or visit newsth.live/MOC2026PA to take the Photo quiz. Top 3 winners* every day win gift vouchers.



CHENNAI METROPOLITAN DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
CHENNAI - 600 008.
AREA PLANS UNIT, RECLASSIFICATION DIVISION.
NOTIFICATION NO. R1/05/2026

Chennai Metropolitan Development Authority(CMDA) has received the following applications for reclassification of land use and the details of the same are furnished below:

Sl. No.	NAME & ADDRESS OF THE APPLICANT	CMDA REF. NO.	SITE ADDRESS, SURVEY NO, VILLAGE NAME, TALUK NAME & DISTRICT NAME	EXTENT OF THE SITE IN HECT. / SQ.M. / ACRE	LAND USE AS PER SECOND MASTER PLAN FOR CMA 2026	CHANGE OF LAND USE REQUESTED BY THE APPLICANT AND ITS PURPOSE
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
1	Thiru S.Saravanan and Tmt. G.S.Bhagirathy, Plot No.1491, Sai Sparsh Apartment, Flat 3B, Ram Nagar, Madipakkam, Chennai- 600 091.	R1/0069/2026	Survey Nos. 233/3C and 233/82, Ottiyambakkam Village, Tambaram Taluk, Chengalpattu District, St. Thomas Mount Panchayat Union Limit.	0.08.86 Ha. (as per Patta) (or) 0.24Ac (as per document)	Agricultural Use Zone	Residential Use Zone to develop a residential layout.
2	Thiru.D.Srinivasan, Door No.5, Kandan Street, Perambur, Chennai-600 011.	R1/0105/2026	Survey Nos.289/2, 290, 291, 317/2, 318/1B & 318/2, 319, 320, 321, 322/1, 323 and 325/1 of Budur Village, Ponneri Taluk, Thiruvallur District, Sholavaram Panchayat Union limit.	1.55.58 Ha. (as per Patta) (or) 3.78 Acres (as per document)	Primary Residential Use zone	Industrial Use Zone to construct a Bakery and Confectionery Industry with 500 workers and 500HP.
3	Thiru.M.Suresh, Door No.152/A, Plot No.152/A, North Street, Pachai Vinnavanur, Thiruvannamalai- 606704.	R1/0110/2026	Survey No.90/2, Perungavur Village, Ponneri Taluk, Thiruvallur District, Sholavaram Panchayat Union limit.	0.47.78 Ha. (as per Patta) (or) 1.18 Acres (as per document)	Agricultural Use zone	Industrial Use Zone to construct a reprocessing of waste plastic including PVC Industry with 25 workers and 150 HP.
4	Thiru. M.Arul David singh, M/s. Jones Foundations Private Limited represented by its Managing Director, M.Jones for themselves and GPA of Tmt. Sheeba Gerald Hendry and other, No.2, Moovarasampet Main Road, Madipakkam, Chennai- 600 091.	R1/0114/2026	Survey Nos. 29/5B1 Apart, 5B2, 6, 7part, 10, 11, 12A, 12B, 12C, 12D and 29/13, Mullaicheri (Moolachery Village as per revenue records), Tambaram Taluk, Chengalpattu District, St. Thomas Mount Panchayat Union limit.	1.22.50 Ha. (as per Patta) (or) 3.05Ac. (as per document)	Agricultural Use Zone	Residential Use Zone to develop a residential plots
5	Tmt.Devipriya.B and two others, No.13/16, Royal Stray F2, Natarajan Street, Tambaram PO, Tambaram Sanatorium, Chennai- 600 047.	R1/0118/2026	Survey Nos.520/3A, and plot No.10 forming part of approved layout PPD/LO No. 89/2021 comprised in survey nos. 522/2B1A1 and 522/3A1A1A1, Nedungundram Village, Vandalur Taluk, Chengalpattu District, Kattankolathur Panchayat Union Limit..	0.08.16 Ha. (as per Patta) (or) 8,784 Sq.ft (as per document)	Partly Road (as per Second Master Plan) and Plot forming part of approved layout	Commercial Use Zone to construct Shops.
6	Thiru.T.Rajan Mathews and Tmt.Lizan Rajan Door No.32, Metha Nagar, Madhavaram Milk Colony, Chennai - 600 051.	R2/0125/2026	Plot Nos. 1759, 1760, 1761, 1762, 1763, 1764, 1765, 1766, 1796, 1797, 1798, 1799 & R-53/2, T.N.H.B.Sites & services, Madhavaram Scheme comprised in T.S.No.61pt & 62pt of Mathur Village, Madhavaram Taluk, Chennai District, Greater Chennai Corporation limit.	24,416 sq.ft (as per document)	Primary Residential Use zone (Residential & Commercial plots forming part of TNHB S&S Scheme)	Institutional Use Zone to construct a School building
7	Thiru.D.Srinivasan and S.Gowtham, Door No.5, Kandan Street, Perambur, Chennai-600 011.	R1/0126/2026	S.Nos.304, 305, 306/1 & 306/2, 308/1A and 308/2, Budur Village, Ponneri Taluk, Thiruvallur District, Sholavaram Panchayat Union limit.	1.38.48 Ha. (as per Patta) (or) 3.42 Acres (as per document)	Mixed Residential Use zone	Industrial Use Zone to construct a Bakery and Confectionery Industry with 300 HP and 300 workers.
8	The Chief Engineer, Tamil Nadu Urban Habitat Development Board (TNUHDB), No.5, Kamarajar Salai Chennai- 600 005.	R2/5011/2026	T.S. No.4, Block No.3, Alandur Village, Guindy Taluk, Chennai District, Greater Chennai Corporation Limit.	2.89.31 Ha. (As per TSLR and as per G.O.)	Partly Institutional Use Zone and partly road	Residential Use Zone to construct 5 Blocks of High Rise building with Stilt + 14 floors for 1793 dwelling units.
9	The Executive Engineer and Administrative Officer, Tamil Nadu Housing Board, Nandanam Division, 18/9, 5th Floor, TNHB Office Complex, B Wing, 1st Main Road, CIT Nagar, Chennai – 600 035.	R2/7031/2026	R.S.No.4593/1, 4593/29 and 4593/33, Block No.102, Mylapore Village, Mylapore Taluk, Chennai District, Greater Chennai Corporation limit.	8.64.675 Ha. (as per Patta) (or) 15 Caw. 26 grds. and 4,449 Sq.ft (as per document)	Partly Primary Residential Use Zone, partly Institutional Use Zone, partly Open Space and Recreational Use Zone and partly Non Assigned	Commercial Use Zone to construct Commercial Complex.

The land use maps relating to all the above reclassification requests are available for inspection in this office between 3.00 PM to 5.00 PM on any working day at the Counselling & Consultancy Counter (Information / Reception Counter) of the office of Chennai Metropolitan Development Authority, Thalamuthu-Natarajan Building, No. 1, Gandhi Irwin Road, Egmore, Chennai - 600 008 and the same is also available in the official website of Chennai Metropolitan Development Authority (CMDA) and can be accessed using the following link - <https://www.cmdachennai.gov.in/LUMaps/index>. Any person who intends to make any objection / suggestion / representation regarding the above variation proposals may do so in writing / e-mail (mscmda@tn.gov.in) to the Member-Secretary, Chennai Metropolitan Development Authority within 21 days from the date of this Notification.

MEMBER SECRETARY,
CHENNAI METROPOLITAN DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY, CHENNAI - 600 008.

DIPR/ 783 /Display/2026



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CYK 9 A CH-CH

From Page One

New Secretariat to come up at Pattinapakkam

According to the G.O. issued by the Public Department, based on the announcement by the Chief Minister, the State government has identified 21.76 acres of land under the possession of the Tamil Nadu Housing Board, 0.93 acres of Greater Chennai Corporation land, 1.73 acres of Revenue Department land, and 1.13 acres of Tamil Nadu Housing Board land under the possession of the State government at Foreshore Estate. This land falls under Mylapore town.

The State government also constituted three committees – a committee to call for Expressions of Interest and finalise the architectural consultancy firm; a committee to finalise building drawings and designs at the preliminary design stage; and another to finalise building drawings and designs at the final design stage, the order said.

The State government had already obtained no-objection certificates through letters from the Managing Director of the Tamil Nadu Housing Board; Commissioner of the Greater Chennai Corporation; and District Collector of Chennai for utilising the land.

INBRIEF

DMK to stage protest against Vijay’s remarks about Stalin

The DMK has announced demonstrations at its headquarters in all districts on September 12, in condemnation of Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay’s Assembly speech denigrating party president M.K. Stalin over his arrest during the Emergency. “He ridiculed Kalaigiar, who was the Chief Minister of the State five times; Murasoli Maran, a world-renowned political expert; and M.K. Stalin, who was arrested under MISA [Maintenance of Internal Security Act, 1971] when he was just 23, and tortured in prison. The Chief Minister has ridiculed the sacrifice of our leader M.K. Stalin. Tamil Nadu has never witnessed such an abhorrent speech,” a statement from the DMK headquarters said. It said Mr. Vijay resorted to indecent and uncivil speeches as he was unable to answer questions on the failures of his government.

DMK names candidates for bypolls in two T.N. Assembly constituencies

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

DMK president M.K. Stalin on Wednesday announced his party’s candidates for the bypolls to be held in Madurantakam and Dharapuram Assembly constituencies on October 6.

Party’s legal wing deputy secretary I. Paranthamen, who previously served as the MLA for Egmore constituency, has been fielded in Madurantakam (Chengalpattu district), while S. Suganya, an advocate and member of the DMK Women’s Wing, is the candidate for Dharapuram (Tiruppur district).

Both the reserved constituencies fell vacant following the resignation of AIADMK legislators Maragatham Kumaravel (Madurantakam) and P. Sathyabama (Dharapuram), who later joined the ruling TVK.

Puducherry candidate
The DMK has declared K. Sethu Selvam as party candidate for the bypoll in Thattanchavady constituency in Puducherry. Mr. Selvam, a former member of the Communist Party of India (CPI), had met Mr. Stalin on Wednesday at Chennai before his candidature was announced. As the CPI candidate for Thattanchavady in 2021 Assembly poll, Mr. Selvam had come second, fighting against Chief Minister and AINRC founder N. Rangasamy.

Alliance led by TVK gets formal title; Vijay to be its chairperson

It has been named Secular Social Justice Victory Alliance. Efforts will be made to draft a Common Minimum Programme, says Manickam Tagore

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The post-poll alliance led by the ruling Tamilaga Vetti Kazhagam (TVK) in Tamil Nadu, comprising the Congress, the Indian Union Muslim League (IUML), the Viduthalai Chiruthaigal Katchi (VCK), and the Marumalarchi Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (MDMK), has been named the Secular Social Justice Victory Alliance (SSJVA).

The alliance was formally given the name at the second meeting of the alliance partners at the TVK headquarters in Panaiyur on the outskirts of Chennai on Wednesday.

TVK president and Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay has been named the chairperson of the alliance. It has been decided that the alliance partners will work together both in Tamil Nadu and Puducherry.

After the meeting, Tamil Nadu Congress Committee president Manickam Tagore, IUML national president K.M. Khader Mohideen, VCK founder Thol. Thirumavalavan, and MDMK leader Vaiko, along with TVK senior leaders and Ministers Aadhav Arjuna and K.G. Arunraj, addressed a joint press conference announcing the



Secular front: Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay and leaders of TVK’s allies at the second meeting of the post-poll coalition at the TVK headquarters in Panaiyur on Wednesday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

name of the alliance.

Mr. Tagore said candidates, on behalf of the alliance, for the upcoming bypolls to Madurantakam and Dharapuram would be announced on Thursday.

Describing the alliance as a strong ideological formation, he said efforts would be made to bring more parties into it and a Common Minimum Programme would be drafted.

Mr. Thirumavalavan said secularism and social justice were the two core ideologies of the alliance and that it was opposed to communal forces. Mr. Vaiko said district-level alliance coordination meetings would be held.

To a question on who the Prime Ministerial candidate for the 2029 Lok

Sabha election would be, Mr. Tagore said the parties that are currently a part of the SSJVA were also constituents of the INDIA bloc at the national level. The TVK would become part of the INDIA bloc once it had an Member of Parliament.

The Prime Ministerial candidate of the INDIA bloc would be announced closer to the 2029 Lok Sabha election and Mr. Vijay would campaign for the candidate, he added.

The parties now in the SSJVA were part of the DMK-led Secular Progressive Alliance during the 2026 Assembly election. They joined hands with the TVK after the declaration of the election results, in which the TVK fell short of a majority.

Political leaders, fisherfolk oppose choice of Pattinapakkam as site for Secretariat

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

PMK president Anbumani Ramadoss on Wednesday said the State government’s decision to construct a new Assembly in Pattinapakkam lacked “foresight”, as the area was already congested.

While there was no disagreement over the need for a new Secretariat, the disadvantages of building a secretariat in Pattinapakkam would outweigh the advantages, he said.

“The biggest problem is traffic congestion. Severe congestion already exists on Santhome Road and Pasumpon Muthuramalingam Salai, which is why a

loop road has been built to help address the problem. The area is also home to several key buildings, including Santhome Church, prominent schools, and the office of the Inspector General of Registration, which attract a large number of people,” he said.

Dr. Anbumani also said the land identified was not sufficient for the new Secretariat and Legislative Assembly complex. “A functioning Secretariat complex would require facilities such as a fire station, emergency medical services, restaurants, parking facilities, and public transport. If all these infrastructure facilities are created within the identi-



Facing resistance: An aerial view of the site in Pattinapakkam, where the government has announced the construction of the Legislative Assembly and Secretariat complex. B. JOTHI RAMALINGAM

fied site, it would be impossible to prevent the kind of space constraints faced in the existing Secretariat

complex from occurring in the new complex, and that too very soon,” he said.

AMMK general secre-

tary T.T.V. Dhinakaran on a social media post called upon Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay to look for other

sites for the new complex, citing various disadvantages of the proposed site, including adverse impact on the livelihood of fishermen living nearby. A public hearing should have been held before choosing the site, he added.

‘Will impact livelihood’
The proposal to construct the Secretariat at Foreshore Estate has not gone down well with fishermen of villages from Nochikuppam to Srinivasapuram along the Marina Loop Road. They say their livelihood will be completely affected and freedom curtailed if the Secretariat is to come up there.

Community leader K.

Bharathi said the implementation of the Blue Flag beach scheme and the use of the Marina Loop Road for traffic movement already hindered their work.

“We don’t have space on beach sands to park our boats, store, and mend nets or sell fish. A small mud road linking the fishing communities along the coast has become a key thoroughfare used by everyone. The courts and officials are telling us that we cannot claim these spaces as our right without understanding the nature of our livelihoods. If the Secretariat is built here, our very existence would become difficult due to heightened security,” he said.

V.R. Vijayan, Maylai Padugudi Anaithu Meenava Grama Panchayat Sabhai said over 1,500 families belonging to the fishing community would have nowhere to go if the complex was constructed there.

The lands identified for the Secretariat belonged to community leader Sindhanai Sirpi Singaravelar, who had gifted it to the communities. “We have been demanding that the land be returned to us,” he said.

On Tuesday, representatives of 140 villages from Tiruvallur to Chengalpattu will meet and pass a resolution against the government’s decision, and also plan the next course of action.

Proposed expansion of Karaikal Port evokes strong opposition

The Hindu Bureau
KARAİKAL

Environmentalists, fishermen, and residents of Karaikal and Nagapattinam have raised strong objection to the proposal of the Karaikal Port Private Ltd. – a subsidiary of Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone Ltd. – to augment by four times its cargo handling capacity to meet the growing need for imports and exports.

Participating in the public hearing hosted by the Puducherry Pollution Control Committee here on Wednesday, former MLA M.G.K. Nizamudeen said the proposed expansion plan was against the interest of the people, particularly fishermen, of Karaikal, Nagapattinam, and Nagore, and that it would cause severe air and water pollution. The public hearing was not conducted in a proper manner, he alleged.

P. Kaliammal, an AIADMK functionary, said the existing port had already caused health hazards to fisherfolk in the nearby areas due to the pollution of sea water. The livelihood of the fishing community would be severely hit due to the enhanced port activities, he said.

Draft EIA report
In its draft Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA) for the Master Plan of Karaikal Port, the Karaikal Port Pvt. Ltd. said the existing port was capable of handling dry bulk, general cargo (break bulk), and liquid cargo, with an overall cargo handling capacity of 21.5 Million Metric Tonnes Per Annum (MMTPA), and operated five berths without any dedicated containers. There was a strong need for increasing the handling capacity.

To handle the cargo from the neighbouring re-

finery, which was developing in a big way, a Single Point Mooring (SPM) and associated facilities will be installed at 19.5 km from within the sea limit of Karaikal and landfall point at Karaikal Port Area, close to the existing jetty area.

The SPM & offshore/onshore pipeline will be designed to handle crude oil receipt by very large crude carriers. The draft EIA report added that with the creation of various infrastructure, the total cargo handling capacity of the port will be increased from 21.50 MMTPA to 100.3 MMTPA, and the port area from 243 hectares to 492 hectares.

It required additional area for establishing facilities such as material handling, cargo storage/back-up, cargo terminals, liquid terminals, operational and utility area, internal connectivity, drainage, greenbelt and buildings.

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Minister for Hindu Religious and Charitable Endowments (HR&CE) S. Ramesh on Wednesday launched a coffee table book titled *The Goddess’s Realm: Meenakshi-Sundareswarar Temple in Madurai*, brought out by The Hindu Group.

Mr. Ramesh said that after discussing with Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, the government had announced the setting up of virtual reality history halls in prominent temples. He appreciated *The Hindu* for bringing out a comprehensive and informative book on the Arulmigu Meenakshi Amman temple, Kumbabhishekam of which is scheduled for September 17.

The first copy of the book was given to N. Murali, Chairman of the Board of Directors of The Hindu



Minister S. Ramesh, N. Murali, Chairman of the Hindu Group Publishing Pvt. Ltd., and Directors Nirmala Lakshman, N. Ravi, and Rohit Ramesh at the launch of the coffee table book on Wednesday. M. SRINATH

Group Publishing Private Limited. N. Ravi, Director, Kasturi and Sons Limited; Nirmala Lakshman, Director and Publisher, The Hindu Group; Rohit Ramesh, Director; and L.V. Navaneeth, Chief Executive Officer, were present.

The book has been illustrated with over 300 black and white and colour pho-

tographs, with 252 pages printed in matt art paper.

It features a wide variety of stories ranging from the origin and development of the temple complex, its breathtaking art and architecture, and series of exquisite mandapams to the various festivals, the saints associated with the temple, and the contribution

Minister launches The Hindu’s coffee table book on Meenakshi-Sundareswarar Temple in Madurai

and punishment, how Mahatma Gandhi made an appearance in a mural of the divine wedding of Goddess Meenakshi, a British Collector’s devotion to the goddess, the drummer who announces the start of worship twice a day, the grandfather who wields a fan of peacock feathers during the grand Chithirai festival, and so on.

The book, curated by former Associate Editor of *Frontline* T.S. Subramanian, also discusses why the temple attracts thousands of devotees from all over India. The book, which includes articles by several scholars, historians, and epigraphists, is available for purchase on The Hindu Group’s online bookstore publications.thehindugroup.com. The cover price of this coffee-table book is ₹2,999, and a launch offer of 25% discount can be availed for a specific period of time.

CM to visit London on first official overseas trip; launch of gold ring scheme put off

N. Sai Charan
CHENNAI

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay is set to embark on his first official overseas visit since assuming office, travelling to London on Thursday to attract investments and hold discussions with entrepreneurs and industrialists.

As a result of his week-long visit, the launch of TVK government’s flagship scheme *Thaimaman Thanga Mothiram Thittam* has been postponed.

Sources said Mr. Vijay would leave from Chennai airport on Thursday night and arrive in London on Friday. He is expected to return on September 17.

During his stay in London, Mr. Vijay will meet entrepreneurs and industrialists and hold discussions with them regarding Tamil Nadu’s investment potential, and highlight the State’s strengths as an investment destination. A couple of important Memoranda of Understanding between the Tamil Nadu government and multinational companies are also likely to be signed, in the presence of Mr. Vijay.

The Chief Minister is also set to visit motorsport facilities and a motorsport circuit in London. This follows his recent announcement in the Assembly under Rule 110 that a motorsport city with modern facilities would be esta-

blished in Tamil Nadu.

Mr. Vijay will also meet members of the Tamil diaspora in London and hold discussions with them. He will be accompanied by his Secretaries I and IV and senior officials of Guidance Tamil Nadu.

Sources clarified that there was no change in Mr. Vijay’s travel schedule amid reports that his itinerary could be altered in view of Malaysian Prime Minister Anwar Ibrahim’s proposed visit to Chennai.

In view of Mr. Vijay’s absence, the launch of *Thaimaman Thanga Mothiram Thittam*, a welfare scheme under which a gold ring will be gifted to babies born in government hospitals, has been postponed. It was originally scheduled for September 15.

After inaugurating a number of facilities at the Rajiv Gandhi Government General Hospital in Chennai, Health Minister K.G. Arunraj told reporters that an official announcement on the revised date and venue would be issued soon.

Asked about quality checks, he said the rings were made of 916 hallmarked gold and the samples would be tested.

Sources said the expansion of Perunthalaivar Kamarajar Breakfast Scheme to students of Classes VI to VIII, scheduled for launch on September 17, was also likely to be postponed.

Ahead of extradition, idol theft accused to be handed to Centre

R. Sivaraman
CHENNAI

International antiques dealer Subash Chandra Kapoor, who is in a Tiruchi jail in Tamil Nadu for idol theft, is likely to be handed over to the Union government authorities soon, following an order of the Madurai Bench of the Madras High Court to repatriate him to Germany, sources said.

Kapoor, who has been accused of involvement in a number of idol theft cases in the State as well as in other countries, is a U.S. citizen. He was extradited from Germany to India in 2012 in connection with a case registered by the Udayarpalayam police in 2008 over the theft of 19 idols from a temple. As part of the extradition process, India had assured Germany that Kapoor would not be prosecuted in any case other than the one for which he was extradited, without Germany's consent.

Multiple cases

He was convicted in that case by the Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate, Kumbakonam, in November 2022 and sentenced to 10 years' imprisonment. After taking into account the period already spent in custody, he completed his sentence and was due for release in February 2023. However, he was subsequently arrested by the Idol Wing CID in four other cases and continued to remain lodged in the Central Prison at Tiruchi.



Subash Chandra Kapoor

Germany and the U.S. had also sought his extradition in connection with cases pending against him in those countries.

In December last year, Kapoor filed a *habeas corpus* petition before the Madurai Bench, contending that his continued detention in other cases without Germany's consent violated the Extradition Treaty between India and Germany.

Meanwhile, the Union government sought to take custody of Kapoor and produce him before the Extradition Court in Patiala House, New Delhi. The High Court held that his continued detention was without authority of law and could not be sustained in the absence of the consent of the requested State, as required under the Extradition Act, 1962, and the Extradition Treaty. The court directed the Union government to take custody of Kapoor from the Central Prison, Tiruchi, within two weeks and proceed in accordance with law to return him to Germany.

Kapoor's advocate A. Manoj Kumar said his client would now be repatriated to Germany.

ED searches premises linked to Jarkiholi, his MP daughter

Agency examining Karnataka PWD Minister's overseas investment, business ventures; searches unrelated to the alleged corruption in Excise department; new case registered against Jarkiholi

The Hindu Bureau
BELAGAVI/BENGALURU

The Directorate of Enforcement (ED) on Wednesday began conducting searches at the residences and other premises linked to Karnataka Public Works Department (PWD) Minister Satish Jarkiholi and his daughter Priyanka Jarkiholi, who is a Congress MP from the Chikkodi Lok Sabha constituency.

The ED clarified that the latest searches against the Jarkiholis are not related to its searches in June over alleged corruption in the Excise Department, but is an independent new case



Under the scanner: Searches are being carried out at 18 locations, including Bengaluru, Belagavi and Gokak. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

against the PWD Minister. There is no clarity as to whether the searches are being carried out under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act, 2002 or the Foreign Exchange Management Act, 1999, the two

laws under which the ED can probe.

The Minister's alleged overseas investment, and his business ventures are being examined, an officer said.

When last checked be-

fore going to print on Wednesday night, the searches were still on. ED sources said they have registered a case against Mr. Jarkiholi.

The searches are being carried out at their residences in Bengaluru, Belagavi, and Gokak, apart from other places. Eighteen locations, including houses of family members, associates, and businesses linked to the Jarkiholi family, are also being searched.

In June this year, the agency claimed that an "organised syndicate involving public officials, intermediaries and private individuals are engaged in systematic collection and distribution of bribes".

ED move in CMRL case 'shameful': Vijayan

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

Leader of the Opposition in Keralam Pinarayi Vijayan on Wednesday struck a defiant tone as the Congress-led United Democratic Front (UDF) government "actively reviews" the Enforcement Directorate's (ED) demand to incriminate him, his daughter T. Veena and son-in-law and former Minister P.A. Mohamed Riyas, in what has come to be known as the CMRL-Exalogic "pay-off" case.

Speaking at the inauguration of the Communist

The agency has asked Kerala Police Chief to register a case against him, family under PCA

Party of India (Marxist)'s [CPI(M)] local committee office at Mannar in Alappuzha, Mr. Vijayan termed the ED's request to the State Police Chief (SPC) to register a case against him and his family under the Prevention of Corruption Act (PCA) as a "shameful" subversion of the criminal justice system for political ends.

"...the ED is attempting a new tack to achieve the political aim of its controllers and those who play second fiddle to its masters by sending a brazenly false set of accusations, masked as a report, to the State's law enforcement to implicate me in a corruption case," he said.

The former Chief Minister also sought to defend his daughter, who is at the centre of the controversy.

The ED had accused Ms. Veena's now-defunct firm, Exalogic Solutions, a software consultancy, of receiving sizeable amounts of money from the CMRL,

a company in which the government has a minority stake, allegedly without providing any tangible service during the 2017-2021 period.

Meanwhile, at a press conference on Wednesday, Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan said that the State government will take an appropriate decision after a legal scrutiny of the allegations raised by the ED in its detailed report to the SPC.

"Major" allegations have been raised in the letter seeking the registration of a separate FIR under the PCA in the case, said Mr. Satheesan.

Another pregnant woman taken by bullock cart to an ambulance

Abhinav Deshpande
HYDERABAD

An ambulance was available, but the road was not. A pregnant woman in Telangana's Kumuram Bheem Asifabad district had to be ferried on a bullock cart to reach a 108-ambulance stranded a few kilometres away.

Karishma, a resident of

Sarkepalli in Wankidi mandal, bordering Maharashtra, went into labour on September 5. Her family contacted the 108 emergency ambulance service, but the vehicle could not reach the hamlet as the road had become muddy and difficult to negotiate following rain. With no other way left, her family arranged a bullock cart

and transported her across the difficult stretch to where the ambulance was waiting. Ms. Karishma was then taken to Wankidi Government Hospital, where she delivered a baby girl.

Speaking to *The Hindu*, Collector K. Haritha said some remote habitations become temporarily inaccessible to motor vehicles during the monsoon.

'Cargo that fell into sea could impact shoreline'

G. Krishnakumar
KOCHI

A pollution risk assessment by the International Tanker Owners Pollution Federation (ITOPF) on the containers that fell into the sea after a fire aboard the Singapore-flagged vessel *Wan Hai 503* off the Kerala coast on June 9, 2025, has stated shoreline impacts may be experienced in future "due to corrosion of the con-

tainer or loss of integrity of the packaging (likely to be in decades)".

"At this time, ITOPF considers these cargoes do not pose a significant risk to the marine environment," said the container risk assessment report submitted by the vessel's registered owner before the National Green Tribunal.

The vessel was carrying approximately 1,754 containers at the time of the incident.

'Purification' of road leading to KCR's farmhouse rocks Assembly

The Hindu Bureau
HYDERABAD

The controversy over the purification of roads used by Congress Dalit activists to reach Telangana Opposition Leader K. Chandrasekhar Rao's farmhouse in Erravelli with turmeric water, by BRS workers, reverberated in the Assembly with members seeking stringent action against them.

The House expressed its anger after a video surfaced on social media where BRS activist Pavani Goud along with others were seen spraying turmeric and milk on the route leading to the BRS chief's farmhouse. The people in the video claimed that they were purifying the road after the Congress 'goons' made it impure.

Deputy Chief Minister Mallu Bhatti Vikramarka alleged attempts were being made to take society back to the medieval era. He said that society could no longer tolerate such acts of humiliation.

CM orders probe

In the Assembly on Wednesday, Chief Minister Revanth Reddy announced an investigation into the incident.

Later, a delegation of the Congress met Governor Shiv Pratap Shukla and submitted a memorandum seeking his intervention as the highest custodian of the Constitution in the State to protect the dignity, safety and self-respect of Dalits and women, both within and beyond the physical boundaries of the Legislature.

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

OBITUARY

Shri. N. NARASIMHAN
Ex-Department of Telecommunications.
Attained Acharyan Thiruvadi on September 9, 2026 at his residence in Serene Pelican, Pondicherry. Deeply mourned by his family
Contact: Son / Daughter 98452 77967

DEATH

Madambakkam Family Grieves SAD DEMISE OF

M. NAGARAJAN (93yrs)
Retd. Officer IOB
DOB: 24.06.1933 DOD: 08.09.2026
Affectionately called as BOSS
4, Sullivan Street, Santhome, Chennai-4
he departed peacefully leaving behind cherished memories
Always remembered by his family
Dr. Kumaresan MN & Family
Cell: 9840086704

BIRTH CENTENARY

100 YEARS
Birthday Remembrance

S. VAIYAPURI, B.E., F.T.E.,
Retd. Dir. of Technical Edu. TN.
10 Sep 1926 - 04 Dec 1989
You live in our hearts forever
Family Members | 9884058250

IN MEMORIAM

IN MEMORIAM

Mrs. Sarojini Natarajan
26-08-1927 - 10-09-2012
M.A. (English), M.A. (Hindi), M.A. (Sanskrit), SahityaRatna, Praveen, Kovid, Dip. in Gandhian Thought, PG Dipl. in Teaching Eng. PG Dipl. in Translation, Cert. in Bengali, Diploma in French
Retired Principal & Professor of English, Former Office - Bearer: Principals' Association, Madurai Kamaraj University; Women's Voluntary Service, Ramnad Dist; Saravodaya Sangh, Ramnad Dist.
Hindi: Pracharak
Carnatic music vocalist & vainika
Beloved and remembered in our hearts, minds, and souls
N. Ashok, Family & Friends

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

IN MEMORY OF YOUR LOVED ONES

To dedicate a space in this section, Please contact:
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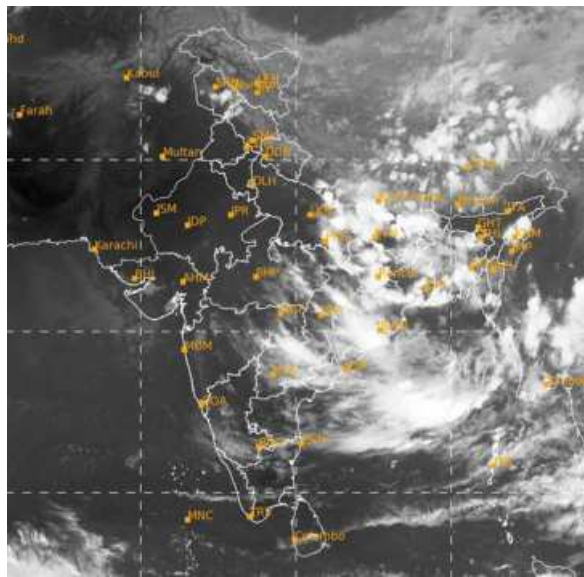
Sri K. R. Ratnam
Retired IA&AS
Departed 05 Sep 2026
Deeply mourned and forever remembered
Celebrated for his brilliant mind and meticulous precision.
Always alive in our hearts.
Ramesh (Son), Sathya & Vidya (Nieces), Girish (Nephew)
+91-7676583750

1st Anniversary Remembrance

Dear VASU
Twelve months without your warm smile and your reassuring voice. Though time moves forward, the memories you gave us and the values you instilled remain timeless. We find comfort in your legacy and carry your spirit with us wherever we go.
 Lovingly remembered by Geeta, Preeti, Prashant, Jyoti, Karan, Ambaa, Aashant, family, friends

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

Forecast for Thursday: Heavy/very heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Uttarakhand, Bihar, Assam, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Tripura, West Bengal, Jharkhand, Odisha, Kerala and Mahe. Thunderstorm with lightning & gusty winds likely at isolated places over Telangana, Andhra Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, Puducherry and Karaikal

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala	3.....	34.6.....	25.5.....	Kurnool		36.0.....	25.2.....
Ahmedabad		36.0.....	26.2.....	Lucknow		34.6.....	26.6.....
Aizawl	46.4.....	31.6.....	20.2.....	Madurai		38.0.....	26.1.....
Bengaluru	0.5.....	30.9.....	21.3.....	Mangaluru	10.6.....	30.2.....	23.9.....
Bhopal		32.0.....	22.5.....	Mumbai		32.1.....	26.2.....
Bhubaneswar		33.2.....	27.4.....	Mysuru	1.....	33.2.....	19.2.....
Chandigarh		35.4.....	24.4.....	New Delhi		36.1.....	27.0.....
Chennai		36.4.....	28.0.....	Patna		35.4.....	27.8.....
Coimbatore		34.1.....	22.5.....	Port Blair		19.3.....	30.4.....
Dehradun		33.9.....	23.5.....	Prayagraj	10.....	34.2.....	25.6.....
Gangtok	17.....	23.5.....	17.9.....	Puducherry		36.2.....	27.0.....
Goa	8.8.....	32.4.....	25.2.....	Pune	8.5.....	30.8.....	20.3.....
Guwahati	4.2.....	34.9.....	25.5.....	Raipur		34.....	26.1.....
Hubbali		31.0.....	21.0.....	Ranchi		17.....	27.6.....
Hyderabad		33.2.....	25.0.....	Shillong	15.....	24.6.....	17.5.....
Imphal		31.3.....	21.8.....	Shimla		26.5.....	19.0.....
Jaipur		35.0.....	25.8.....	Srinagar		32.4.....	15.1.....
Kochi		31.4.....	26.0.....	Thiruvananthapuram		33.0.....	25.0.....
Kohima		26.0.....	18.0.....	Tiruchirappalli		39.7.....	27.4.....
Kolkata	17.9.....	33.6.....	25.5.....	Vijayawada		37.4.....	27.0.....
Kozhikode		34.3.....	26.0.....	Visakhapatnam	6.8.....	34.0.....	27.0.....

(Rainfall data in mm; temperature in Celsius)

Pollutants in the air you are breathing

CITIES	SO ₂	NO ₂	CO	PM _{2.5}	PM ₁₀	CODE	Yesterday
Ahmedabad	22	42	57	46			In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Bulandshahr, Uttar Pradesh recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 241 indicating an unhealthy level of pollution. In contrast, Aizawl, Mizoram recorded a healthy AQI score of 14
Bengaluru	7	219	31		83		
Chennai	5	14	54	46	60		
Delhi	9	8	36	226	108		
Hyderabad	11	19	30	87	90		
Kolkata	9	35	33	46	46		
Lucknow	11	9	42	158	94		
Mumbai	29	9	25	47	55		
Pune	9	25	83	36	86		
Visakhapatnam	16	67	11	62	113		

Air Quality Code: Poor Moderate Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

NO₂: Nitrogen Dioxide. Aggravates respiratory illness, causes haze to form by reacting with other air particles, causes acid rain, pollutes coastal waters.

CO: Carbon monoxide. High concentration in air reduces oxygen supply to critical organs like the heart and brain. At very high levels, it can cause dizziness, confusion, unconsciousness and even death.

PM_{2.5} & PM₁₀: Particulate matter pollution can cause irritation of the eyes, nose and throat, coughing, chest tightness and shortness of breath, reduced lung function, irregular heartbeat, asthma attacks, heart attacks and premature death in people with heart or lung disease

Tamil Nadu Power Generation Corporation Ltd
Notice Inviting Tenders (E-Tendering Process)

Specification No.	Tender Inviting Authority	Name of the Work
03	CE / MTPS - II	Attending to Routine maintenance Minor breakdown works in Air Conditioning 365 days
1	SE / P&A / TT/PS	Disposal of Scrap Materials
01	CE / Electrical / NCTPP-III	NCTPS-III Operation Circle Time Bound work in various Operation locations of BOP area
02	CE / Electrical / NCTPP-III	NCTPS-III Operation Circle Time Bound work in various Operation locations of BTG area
03	CE / Electrical / NCTPP-III	NCTPS-III Operation Circle Time Bound work in various Operation locations of Coal and Oil
04	CE / Electrical / NCTPP-III	NCTPS-III Operation Circle Time Bound work in various Operation locations of FTP RODM plant

For details of works / Procurement / Due date of submission / Opening, viewing and downloading of tenders, please visit websites: www.tangedco.gov.in, www.tenders.gov.in
www.tenders.tn.gov.in **DIPR/2819/Tender/2026**

Tamil Nadu Public Service Commission
TNPS Road, Chennai-600 003.

Notification No. 10/2026 **Dated: 09.09.2026**
Advertisement No. 743

SHORT NOTICE

Tamil Nadu Public Service Commission will hold the Proficiency (written and oral) test in Tamil for Officers of All India Services (I.A.S., I.P.S. and I.F.S.) Officers borne on Tamil Nadu State Cadre whose mother tongue is not in Tamil in its office on 05th October 2026 and 12th October 2026

The last date for receipt of filled in applications in the Commission's office for this examination is **23.09.2026 till 05.45 p.m.**

Further details are available in the Commission's website www.tnpsc.gov.in

Controller of Examinations
DIPR/ 788 /DISPLAY/2026

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, DHENKANAL (R&B) CIRCLE, DHENKANAL

Corrigendum to Bid identification No. C.C.E. DKL (R&B)10/2026-27
Letter No. 1954 /Dtd. 07/09/2026

Due to some modification of the Tender Call Notice No. **C.C.E. DKL (R&B) 10/2026-27**, the bid document for the above tender call notice will be available in the website from **Dt.19.09.2026 to 05.00 PM of 03.10.2026** for online bidding and shall be opened at **11.00 AM on dt. 05.10.2026**.

All other terms and conditions of the above tender call notice will remain unchanged.

C.C.E., Dhenkanal (R&B) Circle, Dhenkanal
OIPR -34001/34132/1-26-27/0014

GREATER CHENNAI CORPORATION
Electrical Department

E.L.D.C.No./SMII/P10/3236/2026 **E-Tender**
E-bids are invited for the following 15 works by SE/Electrical.

1. Operation and Maintenance of street light poles and high masts for a period of one year without material in **Zone 1,2,3,4,6,7,9, 10, 11, 12, 14 & 15 (12 Tenders).**
E-Tender Value: Lowest Value- Rs. 2,18,50,458.84 to Highest value: Rs. 5,27,39,550.12.

2. **E.L.D.C.No. SM II/P10/3414/2026**
Hiring of diesel vehicle fitted with 7 mtr Aluminum ladder, 7mtr working height hydraulic ladder and 12mtr working height hydraulic ladder including driver/cleaner, fuel, oil, driver/cleaner, salaries/bata, insurance and other charges etc. for maintenance of street lights in Zone V, VIII & XIII (Non O&M Zones) for a period of One Year.
E-Tender Value: Lowest Value- Rs.1,05,81,915.75 to Highest value: Rs.1,25,64,468.00
Interested bidders can participate in E-Tender through the website <http://tenders.gov.in> on **07.10.2026** before **2.15 P.M.**, E-Tenders will be opened on **07.10.2026** at **3.15 P.M.** in the chamber of Superintending Engineer.
DIPR/2822/TENDER/2026 **SE/Electrical**

Tamil Nadu Public Service Commission
TNPS Road, Chennai-600 003.

Notification No.:09/2026 **Dated: 09.09.2026**
Advertisement No.:742

SHORT NOTICE

Tamil Nadu Public Service Commission will hold the Half Yearly Examinations and Language Tests for Officers of All India Services (I.A.S., I.P.S. and I.F.S.) and certain classes of Officers of the State serving in Tamil Nadu State from **05.10.2026**.

Applications are invited from the candidates through "ONLINE" mode only for admission to the Half Yearly Examinations and Language Tests – October 2026 Term. The Candidates may apply online through the Commission's website (www.tnpsc.gov.in) from **09.09.2026 to 23.09.2026 till 11.59 p.m.**

Further details are available in the Commission's website www.tnpsc.gov.in.

Controller of Examinations
DIPR/ 788 /DISPLAY/2026

Dangerous phase

The Iran war is plunging the region into an economic and security abyss

The crisis in West Asia is escalating on two fronts. On Tuesday, the U.S. said that its forces had struck five Iranian oil tankers in the Gulf waters after what it claimed were Tehran's attacks on U.S. warships in the region. Iran retaliated with a massive ballistic missile attack on the Muwaffaq Salti U.S. air base in Jordan and vowed to respond with greater force to every U.S. attack from now on. It has also announced a new restricted zone in the Strait of Hormuz, warning commercial ships against crossing it under American naval escort. Separately, Yemen's Houthis, who are closely aligned with Tehran, launched an attack on Saudi Arabia, wounding dozens. Riyadh has vowed a response. The Houthis, who control northern Yemen and parts of its Red Sea coast, have already enforced a naval blockade of Saudi Arabia's western ports and launched an offensive against the forces of Yemen's Saudi-backed government in Taiz and Mocha. With both the Strait of Hormuz, which connects the Persian Gulf with the Gulf of Oman, and the Red Sea, a critical trade channel between Europe and Asia, remaining flashpoints, a horizontally escalating conflict from Tehran to Jordan and Riyadh to Bab-el Mandeb threatens to plunge the entire region into an economic and security abyss.

The current phase of the conflict could prove to be deadlier for several reasons. The U.S., which in the recent past has used intense military strikes and economic strangulation as separate policy tools in an attempt to force Iran to surrender, is now using both simultaneously to exert maximum pressure on Tehran. The U.S. naval blockade has largely prevented Iran from exporting its oil, while the American naval escort to a limited number of ships out of the Strait of Hormuz has helped Washington blunt the impact of Iran's chokehold on the waterway on global energy prices. But President Donald Trump was wrong if he thought his maximum economic and military pressure would force Iran to make concessions. Iran, instead, decided to escalate the conflict by attacking American warships outside the Persian Gulf, fully aware that this would invite a stronger U.S. military response. Iran appears to believe that it has a window of opportunity with the U.S. heading into its midterm elections within weeks and Mr. Trump remaining politically weak at home. If Iran's strikes on U.S. military vessels signal a clear decision at the top to escalate the conflict, its missile attack on U.S. bases in Jordan suggests that Tehran has been rebuilding its strike capabilities – capabilities that Mr. Trump had claimed were destroyed. As neither Washington nor Iran seems ready to step back from the precipice, the war is set to enter a more dangerous phase with global economic implications.

Ray of hope

Courts are coming down on reflexive arrests of activists

The district administration in Noida, Uttar Pradesh, went to great lengths to detain 25-year-old Delhi University law student and activist Akriti Chaudhary on April 11, 2026, in connection with protests by workers in the city. But on September 2, the Allahabad High Court quashed her National Security Act (NSA) detention, terming it an “abuse of the draconian preventive detention law” and came down heavily on the administration. The High Court's intervention is a silver lining in the dark cloud of extreme executive arbitrariness that is smothering the democratic soul of India. It termed the Noida administration's conduct “despotic”, its allegations against the activist a “concocted story”, and noted that the District Magistrate had passed the NSA detention order “without application of mind”. Without mincing words, the High Court warned that an unhinged bureaucracy could reduce the State of Uttar Pradesh to an “Orwellian dystopia”. The Division Bench of Justices Atul Sreedharan and Achal Sachdev ordered compensation of ₹5 lakh for Ms. Chaudhary, which is to be deducted from the salaries of the officers concerned. The facts of the case were brazenly in contradiction with the claims of the police and the district administration, but it also took a rigorous and conscientious Bench to provide this relief. It noted in its order that Ms. Chaudhary was already in the custody of the police when the violence that she is accused of took place.

The relief from the High Court has not set the activist free, as she is named by the U.P. Police in 11 other cases. It will be a long journey of legal battles to get her the freedom that every citizen in a democratic country deserves. That the police would go to such an extent to make life difficult for someone who stood up for the underprivileged must shock the conscience of the nation. Between April 10 and 18, 2026, industrial and contractual workers in Noida had staged protests demanding a wage hike and wage parity with neighbouring Haryana. On April 13, the protests allegedly turned violent. The Noida Police claimed to have “strong electronic and video-graphic evidence” of incitement against Ms. Chaudhary, and it turned out to be merely that, a claim which could not be established. Ms. Chaudhary could receive legal support and media attention that hundreds of others in comparable situations cannot easily access, while the workers remain trapped in miserable conditions because of oppressive business models and state policies that favour capital owners, with the promises made to them still unfulfilled. Yet, the Allahabad High Court's intervention in Ms. Chaudhary's case is a ray of hope that democratic protests will be heeded rather than suppressed by the strong-arm tactics of the executive.

State's development story cannot be the story of its capital alone. Bengaluru is indeed India's pride and the city that has placed Karnataka on the global map. From Information Technology (IT), startups, aerospace and biotechnology to global corporations and new-generation entrepreneurs, Bengaluru has everything that makes it the pillar of India's economy.

But when opportunities are concentrated in one city, so is the pressure. With a population of around 12.5 million and over 11.5 million vehicles, Bengaluru is already facing enormous pressure on its roads, housing and infrastructure. We need to change the pattern of people from rural areas and other cities migrating to Bengaluru in search of opportunities. This is why cities such as Delhi and Mumbai have developed alternative growth centres such as Gurugram and Noida, and Navi Mumbai and Thane, respectively.

The next steps being taken
Karnataka's next chapter cannot depend on one city. It must create several cities and regions that can become strong economic centres in their own right. Taking investments beyond Bengaluru is not an alternative to strengthening Bengaluru; it is, alongside it, an economic strategy for balanced regional development, local employment, new investments, technology and better opportunities across Karnataka. Through Karnataka Digital Economy Mission (KDEM), key clusters including Mysuru, Mangaluru, Hubballi-Dharwad-Belagavi, Tumakuru, Kalaburagi and Shivamogga are being developed to take Karnataka's digital and knowledge economy beyond Bengaluru.

If a young person can find a technology job in Mysuru, there is less need for him/her to move to Bengaluru. If a Global Capability Centre comes up in Mangaluru, employment can remain within coastal Karnataka. If advanced manufacturing grows across Hubballi-Dharwad-Belagavi, young people from North Karnataka can find opportunities closer home.

The process is already visible. In June 2026, 55 industrial projects worth ₹7,506 crore were



D.K. Shivakumar
The Chief Minister of Karnataka

The State's next chapter cannot depend on one city; it must be powered by many economic engines beyond Bengaluru

approved, with the potential to create more than 28,000 jobs. Of these, 41 are planned outside Bengaluru Urban and Bengaluru Rural districts. In August 2026, another 83 projects worth around ₹6,253 crore were approved, of which 69 are planned outside Bengaluru, with the potential to create more than 30,000 jobs.

These are approved projects and projected employment figures, not completed investments. But they demonstrate that investment is increasingly being directed beyond Bengaluru. The Local Economy Accelerator Programme (LEAP) has been allocated ₹1,000 crore over five years to promote startups, entrepreneurship and emerging technology clusters beyond Bengaluru, with a target of creating five lakh employment opportunities.

Building around each region's strengths
Under the 2026-27 Budget, LEAP Labs are proposed in Hubballi, Kalaburagi, Hoskote and Mysuru, along with a K-Combinator accelerator and stronger industry-academia linkages. Crucially, the aim is not to copy Bengaluru elsewhere. It is to build ecosystems around the distinct strengths of each region.

For instance, coastal Karnataka has strong foundations in ports, maritime connectivity, education, health care, banking, fisheries and tourism, along with a growing knowledge economy. The next step is to connect these strengths with technology and the digital economy. Similarly, Mysuru already has strong foundations in education, tourism and technology. The government has set the goal of developing it as Karnataka's second IT city under the 2026-27 Budget. Mysuru should not be Bengaluru's replacement; it should become another major technology and knowledge-economy engine for Karnataka.

The Hubballi-Dharwad-Belagavi cluster has strong foundations in engineering, manufacturing, education and entrepreneurship. It is being developed as an emerging cluster for Artificial Intelligence (AI), machine learning, Internet of Things and advanced manufacturing. Available KDEM data indicate more than 400

startups and over 80 funded startups in the cluster, with more than 4,500 jobs added. The next step is to build on this foundation through AI, data science, drones, electric vehicles (EV), Software as a Service (SaaS), agritech and advanced manufacturing. Tumakuru and Doddaballapura have been identified as an industrial node with the potential to attract around ₹7,000 crore in investment and create more than 88,000 jobs.

So, clearly, 'Beyond Bengaluru' does not mean giving every district the same development model. It means identifying each region's strengths and building the right economic ecosystem around them.

The 'Beyond Bengaluru' model
The goal is also not simply to build IT parks or factories. Education, skills, health care, connectivity, housing and employment must grow together. When industries come, local Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MSME) must benefit. When jobs are created, local youth must have the necessary skills. As cities expand, workers need quality housing, while their families need schools and health care. Tourism must create income for local communities.

That is why the 'Live Near Work' approach, with quality housing close to industrial areas, is important. Industry and human development are two parts of the same economic system. Agriculture must also be part of this transformation. Drones, satellite imagery, digital technology and AI can support crop surveys, crop-health assessment, pest and disease monitoring and real-time agricultural intelligence. Value addition, food processing and stronger supply chains can further strengthen rural economies.

This 'Beyond Bengaluru' model is one that spreads Bengaluru's success across Karnataka. Bengaluru should remain the crown of Karnataka. But the brilliance of that crown must be visible in every district. It means taking the success of Bengaluru and creating new centres of success across the State – a Karnataka powered by many economic engines.

Turning economic cooperation into shared prosperity

At a time when the international landscape is becoming more complex and uncertain, the case for meaningful international cooperation has rarely been stronger. Its value must increasingly be measured by its ability to deliver stability, resilience and shared prosperity.

For the United Arab Emirates (UAE), this is central to how it approaches BRICS. Since becoming a full member in January 2024, its engagement has been guided by a straightforward principle: economic cooperation should create tangible opportunities for countries, businesses and people.

A diversity that creates opportunities
The strength of BRICS lies partly in its diversity. Its members bring different economic structures, resources, capabilities and development experiences – from major producers and consumers to sources of capital, investment destinations, energy exporters and manufacturing centres.

These differences create opportunities for complementarity – connecting markets, capital, capabilities and ideas in ways that can benefit its members, and by extension the Global South.

The UAE's participation in BRICS is part of its broader commitment to multilateralism, constructive dialogue and diversified international partnerships. It seeks to build bridges between economies and regions. It supports an open international system that advances peace, stability, sustainable development and shared prosperity.

For the UAE, BRICS' ultimate value lies in implementation. Dialogue should translate into easier trade, stronger investment flows, more resilient supply chains, better connectivity and greater opportunities for businesses.

India's 2026 BRICS Chairship, centered on resilience, innovation, cooperation and sustainability, provides a timely framework for this agenda. At a time when trade restrictions, supply-chain disruptions and uncertainty are increasing costs for businesses and consumers, the response should not be to retreat from global economic integration, but to make it more resilient and inclusive.

BRICS stands out when cooperation can produce tangible benefits: through strengthening



Saeed bin Mubarak Al Hajeri
Minister of State at the United Arab Emirates Ministry of Foreign Affairs

The United Arab Emirates promotes open, resilient economic cooperation through its engagement with BRICS

the multilateral trading system, facilitating trade and investment, improving connectivity, supporting resilient global value chains, and promoting sustainable development.

Development finance is also part of this equation. The New Development Bank (NDB) has approved more than \$40 billion in financing since its establishment, supporting infrastructure and sustainable development across its member countries. The UAE's active engagement with the NDB long before joining BRICS reflects its wider commitment to mobilising capital towards productive investment and long-term growth.

The UAE's own economic partnership with India demonstrates what practical connectivity can achieve.

On UAE-India ties, the UAE's advantages
The UAE-India Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement has helped create a more enabling environment for trade and investment between two highly complementary economies. In 2025, non-oil bilateral trade grew by 17% to exceed \$76 billion and the UAE and India have set the ambition of increasing bilateral trade to \$200 billion by 2032.

But the strength of the UAE-India relationship extends beyond trade. It is reinforced by investment, innovation, education, tourism and long-standing connections between their businesses, institutions and people.

This experience points to a broader lesson for BRICS: the strongest economic partnerships are built not only through agreements between governments, but through lasting connections across societies – creating the trust, opportunity, and resilience that allow commercial ties to deepen over time.

Economic connectivity is strengthened when businesses, entrepreneurs, investors, and institutions develop greater familiarity with one another. It is reinforced through education, research, tourism, cultural exchange and engagement of younger generations, which help build the trust and networks on which longer-term economic relationships grow.

The opportunity for BRICS is therefore to deepen the quality of connectivity among its members – connecting not only economies but also institutions, ideas and people.

The UAE is particularly well positioned to contribute because connectivity lies at the heart of its own economic model.

Non-oil sectors accounted for almost 79% of GDP in 2025, supported by world-class infrastructure, trusted financial institutions, advanced logistics and energy capabilities, and an open investment environment that enables businesses to scale-upwards and outwards.

The UAE's ports, airports and logistics networks connect markets across Asia, Africa, Europe and beyond. Its financial centres connect international capital with opportunities across the region, while, its universities, research institutions and innovation ecosystem connect talent, knowledge and ideas.

With sovereign wealth assets exceeding \$2.9 trillion, and 38 concluded Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreements, the UAE has built the capacity to connect capital, markets and economies at scale.

For the UAE, connectivity is not simply about moving goods from one market to another. It is about creating the conditions in which capital, knowledge, technology, talent and people can interact and create new opportunities.

The UAE's approach is not to build economic cooperation around division, but around connectivity.

The path under India's leadership
As India leads BRICS through 2026, there is an opportunity to move further toward delivery: building resilience without closing markets, supporting innovation while widening opportunity, and strengthening connections among the businesses, institutions and people of the UAE and India. The UAE also looks ahead with confidence to China's BRICS Chairship in 2027, where it hopes to build on the momentum of India's leadership and carry forward the same energy of openness, connectivity and practical cooperation.

Ultimately, the success of BRICS cooperation will be measured by the opportunities it creates. That is the approach that the UAE brings to BRICS. As India hosts the 2026 Summit (September 12-13), the UAE stands ready to continue the work that translates cooperation into ways that support shared prosperity.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Dhaka and Sheikh Hasina
Bangladesh's demand for Sheikh Hasina's extradition has placed India in a delicate diplomatic position. Dhaka wants Ms. Hasina to return to face charges related to the student uprising, while India must balance its earlier close ties with the deposed leader against its relations with the present Bangladeshi government. The best option is neither immediate extradition nor outright refusal, but a strictly legal and diplomatic approach. India should examine the request under the extradition treaty and

seek assurances of a fair trial, due process and protection from political persecution, while maintaining dialogue with Dhaka. This would protect India's credibility, avoid confrontation and preserve long-term bilateral relations.
R.S. Narula,
Patiala, Punjab

BRICS is a multilateral organisation and it would be beneficial for Bangladesh to participate in the summit at the highest level. However, linking its participation to Sheikh Hasina's extradition may

not be a smart foreign policy approach. As neighbours linked by civilisational ties and practical considerations, such as a shared border and water-sharing arrangements, it would be in the national interests of both India and Bangladesh to set aside sensitive issues such as Ms. Hasina's extradition and move forward with their bilateral and multilateral relations.
Kosaraju Chandramouli,
Hyderabad

Belated search for peace
There is talk of India exploring ways to

contribute to ending the ongoing Russia-Ukraine conflict. One cannot help but wonder why it has taken so long. The war has caused an enormous loss of life, destruction and suffering. What is particularly distressing for Indians is the reported recruitment of Indian nationals who went to Russia in search of employment but were subsequently drawn into military service and sent to the war front. If Indians were deceived or coerced into fighting a foreign war, should not the Indian government have taken a

much stronger position and demanded accountability? For over a decade, India has repeatedly projected itself as a country capable of speaking to both sides. Yet, when there are signals that India is seeking ideas that could contribute to ending the conflict, the initiative sounds rather belated.
Tharcus S. Fernando,
Chennai

Eiffel Tower 'incident'
The revolutionaries of 1789 articulated their demands around three core principles: liberty, equality and fraternity. Yet, we are witnessing a troubling

departure from these very ideals in the controversy surrounding the recent protest at the Eiffel Tower – and the allegation of asking women staff to make themselves invisible. The incident calls for deeper introspection. Even as societies aspire to progress and global leadership, institutional practices can continue to perpetuate attitudes that overlook systemic gender discrimination.
Rishika Singh,
Dhanbad, Jharkhand

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

India has to act on its ‘sugar’ problem

This week, the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI), prodded by the Supreme Court, proposed a simple but overdue idea. Packaged foods high in fat, salt, or sugar should carry a bold red warning on the front of the pack, not buried in fine print on the back. Someone picking up instant noodles, a breakfast cereal, or a “health drink” will finally be told, at a glance, that it is not as wholesome as its advertising claims. This is a welcome step. It is also, on its own, nowhere near enough.

The number of children presenting with morbid obesity and diabetes has climbed sharply within just a few years. The World Obesity Atlas 2026 bears this out – 41 million Indian children and adolescents aged 5 to 19 are now overweight or obese. This is not just because children are eating more; it is about what they are being sold. Breakfast cereals, sweetened yoghurts, and “health drinks” are marketed to parents as filling gaps in a child’s diet, emphasising “energy” and vitamins while saying little about the sugar content inside. In 2024, a leading multinational was found adding sugar to infant food sold in India and other lower income countries; sugar was left out of the same product in Europe. When a health drink, popular in Indian homes, turned out to be nothing more than flavoured sugar syrup, it took a social media storm, and not a regulator, to force the company to prescribe a 15% cut in its added sugar.

The problem is worse around schools and colleges, where studies show that the cheapest, most easily



Dr. Praveen George Paul

Assistant Professor, Pediatric Endocrinology and Metabolism, Department of Pediatrics, Christian Medical College, Vellore



Dr. Vandana Jain

Professor, Pediatric Endocrinology Division, Department of Pediatrics, All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS)

When the U.K. introduced its soft drinks industry levy, sugar consumption fell. Manufacturers reformulated their drinks to slip below the tax threshold rather than raise prices

available snacks are also the least healthy. A popular “energy drink” among teenagers, priced at just ₹20, packs close to 17 grams of sugar, caffeine, and artificial colour into a single bottle. Its label says it is not meant for children, yet nothing stops a child from buying it. This is the market pricing unhealthy calories to fit within the range of a child’s pocket money.

Need for enforcement

None of this is a secret. What has been missing is enforcement. The FSSAI and the Central Board of Secondary Education (CBSE) have long recommended what schools should not sell, but optional rules get treated as optional, and canteens stock whatever sells cheapest. A red warning label only works if it is actually enforced.

Moreover, the new rule stops at the edge of organised retail. Most of India’s sugar, salt, and trans fat is eaten unbranded, from street stalls, dhabas, and sweet shops that make up the unorganised sector, none of which is required to declare anything. A red label on a biscuit packet does nothing about the jalebi sold loose beside it. Regulation that reaches only packaged food leaves the unregulated half of the plate untouched.

Then there is the conversation India keeps avoiding – a tax on sugar. When the U.K. introduced its soft drinks industry levy, sugar consumption among both children and adults fell. Manufacturers reformulated their drinks to slip below the tax threshold rather than raise prices. A well-designed sugar tax does not just discourage people from buying a product, it pushes the industry to make the

product itself less harmful.

India already taxes sugary drinks heavily; just not usefully. Since September 2025, aerated and sweetened beverages, sugar free versions included, were folded into one 40% GST slab – so a ‘normal’ cola and its zero-sugar counterpart pay the same tax, leaving manufacturers with no reason to cut sugar. The U.K.’s levy worked differently, taxing drinks in tiers by sugar content, so that companies could lower their bill by reformulating the product. India could tax products in the same way so that manufacturers have a reason to cut sugar.

The standard objection – that such a tax would hit the poor the hardest – is not wrong, but it is only half the argument. Unregulated, cheap sugar already extracts a heavy price from the poor, who bear the brunt of the diabetes, hypertension and childhood obesity epidemic that sugar heavy diets drive, with the least means to treat it. Doing nothing is not neutral; it is a slower, costlier tax, paid in ill health rather than rupees at the till. The answer is to design the tax calibrated to sugar content so that it nudges reformulation, with part of the revenue set aside to make healthy food cheaper.

The FSSAI’s proposed red label is a genuine, if belated, first step. What India needs now is the resolve to finish what it has started – mandatory food standards; limits on how unhealthy food is marketed to children; rules that reach the unorganised sector; and an honest debate on taxing sugar in a way that protects families with the least room to absorb either cost, the tax, or the disease.

The many ways to destroy a book

Last month, a group of citizens in Ahmedabad gathered to read books by Pakistani education activist Malala Yousafzai and Holocaust survivor Anne Frank. This was their way of protesting against the Bajrang Dal and Vishwa Hindu Parishad for forcing a private school to drop books by Yousafzai and Frank from its compulsory reading list. Soon, members of the Bajrang Dal arrived at the scene, beat up the group, and tore up the books.

The targeting of books is as old as the book itself. Books have been censored, banned, torn, burnt, and pulverised to suppress opposing views, enforce state ideologies, silence uncomfortable truths, or for being deemed heretical.

Earlier this month, too, the destruction of books was in the news – but for a very different reason. Various reports in international media said that rare-book sellers were surprised to see a sudden increase in sales. However, the books were not being bought by specialised dealers, collectors, or connoisseurs; they were being purchased by buyers with strange names – Red Sparrow Project, Blue Finch Project, and Green Parrot Project – to train Large Language Models (LLMs) such as ChatGPT. These valuable editions ended up in warehouses, where their spines were sliced, their pages scanned, and the books pulped, so that AI companies would not have to deal with the headache of copyright and e-books.

Why are these two different groups targeting books? The Bajrang Dal said it disapproved of Yousafzai’s perceived views on India and Kashmir. Here, there is a



Radhika Santhanam

clear ideological opposition to Yousafzai’s ideas. The organisation carried out the deliberate act of thrashing people and tearing up books to send a clear warning: do not read this book; and if you do, face our wrath.

In the AI case, there is no such ideological opposition. The book is seen by companies as a mere object that contains ideas. And those ideas are not dangerous; on the contrary, they are important because they can be mined for profit. The more the knowledge fed into LLMs, the greater their capacity to respond, and the more dependent we become on them. What makes this even more worrying is that not all such extraction and destruction is seen as damaging to our cultural spaces or as insults to creators. Not too long ago, a U.S. court ruled that Anthropic’s use of copyrighted books to train its AI was not, in itself, copyright infringement. “One replaced the other,” one of the judges wrote. “There is no evidence that the new, digital copy was shown, shared, or sold outside the company.”

This means that within the framework of our current understanding of “fair use”, a company can buy books written by human beings, copy their contents into a machine, and then destroy the books without even having to compensate the writers. Surely, we need to ask ourselves: have we understood the words “fair” and “use” too narrowly?

Why books matter

This practice unsurprisingly sparked widespread anger, which brings us to a more fundamental question: what does the physical book mean to us?

When a book is given to a

child, it can become a precious possession, a way to travel into different worlds of imagination. A book given as a gift by a friend can become a warm memory. A book borrowed from a library for research can be carried around as a vessel of knowledge. A book purchased from a rare-books shop can be as precious as silver, containing layers of history. Books, therefore, have always been more than paper and ink and a spine. They are, of course, textual instruments, but they are also cultural objects – repositories of our thoughts, wanderings, dealings, and feelings. If ideas are what makes us human, books, then, are a physical manifestation of those ideas, which we choose to preserve and pass on.

In *Burning the Books*, Richard Ovenden writes about how, when the National and University Library of Bosnia and Herzegovina came under artillery fire from the Serbian military in 1992, librarians formed a human chain to protect books. In Nazi Germany, a group of Jewish intellectuals, known as the ‘Paper Brigade’, risked execution by hiding books inside their clothing. In the Soviet Union, Samizdat involved clandestinely copying and circulating censored texts, while the modern copyleft movement allows creators to choose to reproduce and share their work freely.

Today, in a world where books are seen either as dangerous or as useful raw material – rather than as things to be read – the ways in which we defend books may have to keep evolving.

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Trade between BRICS countries shows marked increase

The rise in intra-BRICS trade strengthens the case for a cross-border payments system

DATA POINT

Nitika Francis
Gandla Sneha

Reducing global dependence on the U.S. dollar is expected to be a key part of the discussions in the 18th BRICS Summit, chaired by India, happening in New Delhi on September 12 and 13, 2026. Finance ministries’ and central bank governors from BRICS countries met in August to discuss the facilitation of cross-border payments and strengthening of national currencies.

The BRICS bloc with its 10 member countries – Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa, Egypt, Ethiopia, Indonesia, Iran, and the UAE – has grown in strength in its objective of advancing trade and diplomatic relations within the Global South, which makes cross-border payments desirable.

Currently, making payments across countries requires a string of transactions via correspondent banks, which hold accounts with each other. When two countries do not have such correspondent banks, they route their payments through international banks, converting the currency of the sender country to a dominant currency such as dollars, and then converting the dollars to the currency of the receiving country. This process, besides being slow at times, comes with the cost of foreign exchange margins and the fee charged by the intermediaries. Seeing that the BRICS comprises many developing economies, this can be among the many impediments to trade opportunities.

Trade data shows that merchandise exports by BRICS countries made up about one-fourth of all global exports in 2024 (**Chart 1**). The BRICS countries have all drastically increased their exports over the years, with China touching \$500 billion in 2024. Other members such as Brazil, India, Indonesia, Russia, and the UAE also re-

corded large figures between \$80 and \$180 billion. In addition to this, their trade amongst each other has also increased. **Chart 2** shows that as of 2024, all members of BRICS, except China, received more than 30% of imports from other members.

Iran depends on BRICS for more than 65% of its imports, and Ethiopia nearly 45%. Intra-BRICS import dependency could be on the rise due to the heterogeneity of goods available among its members, as noted in a report by the United Nations Conference on Trade and Development.

Concurrently, export dependency within the bloc has also risen. In the last decade, five members (Russia, China, the UAE, Brazil, and Indonesia) have doubled and even quadrupled their exports to members of the bloc. However, China has consistently shown the lowest dependency on intra-BRICS exports due to its diversified export market (**Chart 3**).

Russia saw a rapid increase in its export dependency between 2020 and 2023, in the middle of its invasion of Ukraine, during which countries such as India imported its fuel. The country saw a decline in export dependence in 2024.

It was under Russia’s chairmanship in 2024 that the BRICS argued against the dominance of the U.S. dollar. Russia was hit directly by the dollar monopoly in 2022; due to sanctions from the U.S., Russian banks were cut off from the Society for Worldwide Interbank Financial Technologies (SWIFT) which enables institutions to settle amounts. Hence, international transactions proved difficult for the Russia.

While the U.S. is the largest economy in the world, the BRICS bloc does not fall far behind, as China, India, and Russia are in the top 10 in terms of Gross Domestic Product (current prices) (**Table 1**). Whether this collective economic strength can challenge the dominance of the dollar is to be seen in the coming days.

Dollar detour

The data for the charts were sourced from report by the United Nations Conference on Trade and Development titled “Two Decades of Intra-BRICS Trade: Trends, Patterns and Policies” and the International Monetary Fund (IMF)



CHART 1: In 2025, exports from BRICS countries made up about 25% of global merchandise exports. BRICS countries include Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa, Egypt, Ethiopia, Indonesia, Iran, and the UAE. Values in \$ trillion

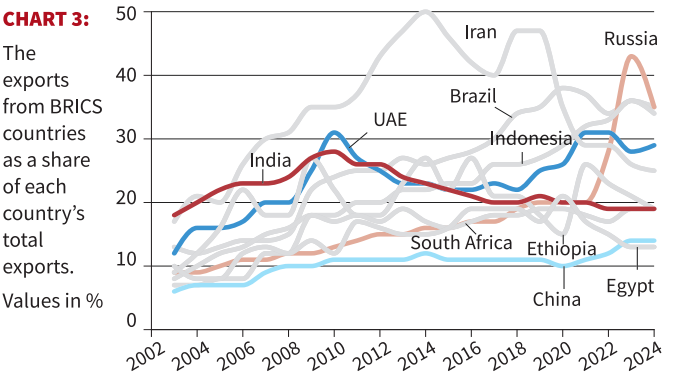
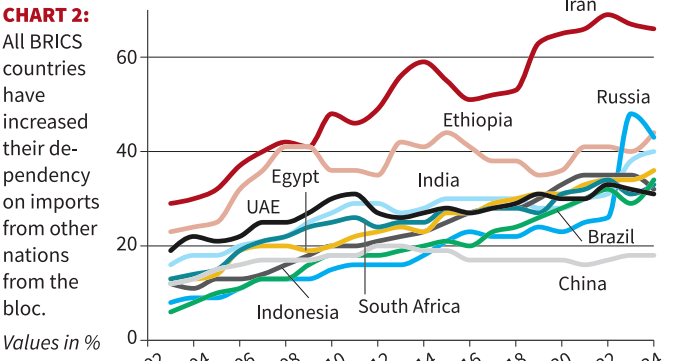
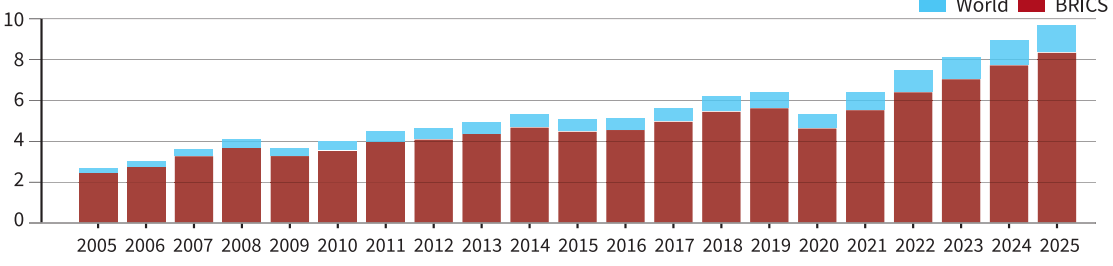


TABLE 1: Country-wise size and ranking of Gross Domestic Product of 2025 (current prices). Values are estimated by IMF

Country	GDP, current prices (billions of \$)	Rank
China	19,626.247	2
India	3,916.312	7
Russian Federation	2,587.938	9
Brazil	2,279.918	12
Indonesia	1,445.642	18
United Arab Emirates	571.643	32
South Africa	427.141	43
Iran	371.196	46
Egypt	364.64	47
Ethiopia	109.109	74

“Collectively, the 10 member countries account for 27 per cent of world output, 24 per cent of merchandise exports, and 22 per cent of FDI inflow by 2024” - Two Decades of Intra-BRICS Trade: Trends, Patterns and Policies report

Gandla Sneha is interning with The Hindu

FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu.

FIFTY YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 10, 1976

Mao Tse-tung dead

Peking, September 9: Mao Tse-tung, the 82-year-old father of Communist China, died to-day at 10 minutes past midnight. Radio Peking broadcast the news to the 750 million Chinese saying: “Mao Tse-tung passed away at 00-10 hours on Sept. 9 because of the worsening of his illness and despite all treatment, although meticulous medical care was given to him in every way after he fell ill.”

Funeral music followed, and immediately thousands of people, wearing black armbands, began to gather in the vast Tien An Men Square (Square of Heavenly Peace) in the heart of Peking. In factories, shops and apartment blocks people gathered around loudspeakers and radio sets. Their faces turned grim and sorrowful at the news of the death of the man who had commanded their reverence and awe. Chairman Mao would have been 83 on December 26. He had been suffering from Parkinson’s disease.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 10, 1926

The Nizam’s protest

The following is from ‘The Daily Herald’ – It is reported from Bombay, says the Indian News Service, that His Exalted Highness, the Nizam of Hyderabad has sent a very strongly worded protest to the Viceroy, urging that in future the relations of the Nizam should be with the Viceroy as representative of the King and not with the Government of India. The Nizam’s contention is that the he had never entered into treaty negotiations with the Indian Government, but only with the British Government.

The Government of India is becoming gradually responsible to the people of India and the Nizam contends, it would be beneath his dignity to owe allegiance to a Government controlled by the people.

The Nizam is strongly supported in this protest by other Indian princes, who look with unconcealed perturbation on the growing encroachment on their “fundamental rights guaranteed by treaties”. The very idea of the Indian people taking to task the old-time rulers is galling to the Maharajahs and Nawabs.

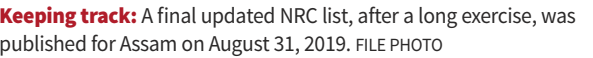
It is a problem which is pressing more and more closely on the Government of India. That Government, however, is anxious, if possible, to postpone the decisive struggle with the old-time rulers – its hands being too full with the problems of the existing situation.

After striking the U.S. base in Jordan on Tuesday night, the Guards said the "punitive operation" damaged maintenance and repair facilities, deployment locations, and shelters for fighter jets. Jordan's army said it had shot down 18 Iranian missiles targeting the kingdom.

The court had asked Ms. Bhati, appearing for the CBSE, to get instructions on three issues – whether a one-time reprieve could be given to the current batch of Class 6 students; how human resources could be built to meet the demands of the three-language scheme; and whether the scheme should ideally be introduced in earlier classes.

The Chief Justice orally assured that the court would seek an explanation for the issuance of the notice. “We will ask for his (Magistrate) explanation... Let him explain,” Chief Justice Kant said.

Speaking to *The Hindu*, former Deputy Registrar General of India K. Narayanan Unni stressed that any link between the Census



Keeping track: A final updated NRC list, after a long exercise, was published for Assam on August 31, 2019. FILE PHOTO

Mr. Unni said, “NPR is generated under the Citizenship Act, and data is supposed to be published. However, Census data is confidential and can only be used for statistical purposes. But in 1951, Census

The 1951 exercise
The NPR had been updated in 2015 and already has the family-wise database of 119 crore residents.

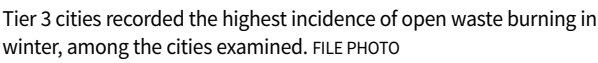
"Many of these details are already available in administrative databases. It is not clear what statistical purpose some of these questions will serve," he said.

The exact number of workers trapped under the collapsed structure was not immediately clear, officials said.

The DoPT clarification comes amid a recent complaint from the National Commission for Scheduled Castes (NCSC) that the Centre's de-reservation proposals were often incomplete and did not re-

In response to queries from *The Hindu* under the Right to Information Act of 2005, the DoPT cited Section 7(9) of the law to say that gathering the information on de-reservation proposals would “disproportionately divert the resources of the public authority”.

The study, based on field surveys from 2019–2026 in 11 polluted Indian

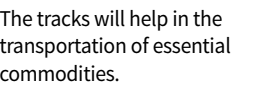


Tier 3 cities recorded the highest incidence of open waste burning in winter, among the cities examined. FILE PHOTO

Open waste burning was not the dominant source of citywide particu-

The burden, the report assessed, was also strongly associated with socio-economic conditions. Poorer areas recorded substantially more burning than higher-income areas, with the highest incidence in the study, at nearly 84 incidents per square kilometre per day, recorded in the poorer areas of Tier 2 cities during winter. The researchers say the pattern points to disparities in waste collection and other municipal services.

The first five projects, covering 17 districts across



The capacity augmentation works will result in ad-

These eight projects will increase the existing network of the Indian Railways by 1,196 km. The projects are planned under the PM-Gati Shakti National Master Plan, with a focus on enhancing multi-modal connectivity and logistics efficiency through integrated planning and stakeholder consultations.

A High Court Division
Bench headed by Justice

Ms. Chaudhary was among several activists arrested in connection with the protest held between April 10 and 18, during which industrial and contractual workers demanded a hike in salary and parity with wages paid in neighbouring Haryana.

The High Court had directed that Ms. Chaudhary be paid compensation of ₹5 lakh, and that the amount be recovered from the salaries of the District Magistrate and “all such other officers who may have been responsible, right down to the Station House Officer” of the police station, who had prepared the initial report warranting the detention of the petitioner under the provisions of the NSA.

MHA proposes new Chapter ‘K’ under Article 371 for Ladakh

Provision being made to bring elected body for Union Territory; civil society members who attended MHA meet say they were ‘disappointed’ as they are yet to receive draft proposal; they also sought compensation for families of violence victims

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

The Union Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) has proposed an elected body for the Union Territory (UT) of Ladakh by introducing a new constitutional provision under Article 371 of the Constitution in a proposed Chapter K, civil society members who attended a meeting with MHA officials in Delhi on Wednesday said.

Cherring Dorjay Lakruk of the Leh Apex Body (LAB) told *The Hindu* that they were “disappointed” as this was a reiteration of the May 22 meeting, and were given a PowerPoint presentation mentioning Chapter K on Wednesday but were yet to get a detailed “draft proposal” from the MHA.

A statement released by the civil society members said, “The MHA stated that the intended UT-level body, would be elected by di-



Making a point: People from Ladakh have staged several protests over the years seeking Statehood. ANI

rect election, and would have legislative powers with respect to land, culture and language, forest, environment, natural resources, and any other subject matter reserved for the UT under Article 240.”

Ladakh chief secretary Ashish Kundra, who attended the meeting, said in a post on X, “Attended the sub-committee meeting with leaders of Ladakh at MHA in Delhi today. A general air of positivity prevailed as the broad con-

tours of a Sui-generis model of governance under Article 371 of the Constitution were discussed. Deepening democracy is the goal.”

Representatives of the LAB and the Kargil Democratic Alliance (KDA) asked the MHA to ensure that the Lieutenant-Governor of Ladakh does not take any major decisions concerning the administration, bureaucracy or land until the proposed constitutional safeguards are put in place,

while pressing for the legislation to be passed in the upcoming Winter Session of Parliament.

The members also sought compensation for the families of the victims of the violence that broke out on September 24, 2025, in Leh city, where four people were killed in police firing. They further sought the withdrawal of criminal cases against 80 people, along the lines of the protection afforded to those who took part in the “Gen Z protest” at Delhi’s Jantar Mantar in July. The violence in Ladakh erupted amid a protest that was called to demand constitutional safeguards.

Article 371, which currently has chapters that run from A to J, deals with “Temporary, Transitional and Special Provisions” and exists under Part XXI of the Constitution. It is currently applicable in 12 States: Nagaland, Assam, Manipur, Mizoram, Maharashtra, Gujarat, Andhra

Pradesh, Telangana, Arunachal Pradesh, Goa, Sikkim, and Karnataka.

After Ladakh lost its special status under Article 370 of the Constitution as part of the erstwhile State of Jammu and Kashmir, it was turned into a Union Territory without a legislative assembly in 2019. Since then, the LAB and the KDA have been demanding Statehood and tribal status for Ladakh and seeking a larger role for local residents in decisions relating to land and infrastructure projects.

Climate activist Sonam Wangchuk, who was also part of the delegation that met MHA officials, said, “We cannot say that the meeting was a complete success. We hoped to get a draft proposal assuring us protection under Article 371. However, that was not provided. We have asked the government to take back the cases registered against protesters after last year’s incident in Leh city.”

Cong. alleges ₹10,000-cr. tax evasion through ‘bogus’ political parties, seeks JPC

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Alleging that 3,260 registered unrecognised political parties (RUPPs) had received political donations and evaded income tax to the tune of ₹10,000 crore, the Congress on Wednesday demanded a Joint Parliamentary Committee (JPC) probe into the “donation scam”.

Addressing a press conference here, Congress MP Shaktisinh Gohil alleged that the parties were being used as a route to convert unaccounted-for money into legitimate political donations by way of round-tripping and other means.

Party general secretary (communications) Jairam Ramesh later alleged that the 3,260 parties were operating under the “patronage” of the BJP. “Who is the ‘Chanakya’ behind these 3,260 sham political parties and who is the true mastermind of this scam?” Mr. Ramesh asked on X.

He also contrasted the alleged tax evasion with



Shaktisinh Gohil

the Congress’s experience before the 2024 Lok Sabha election, when its bank accounts were frozen and it received tax notices. “So, why is there no investigation into these 3,260 sham political parties and the associated cases of tax evasion,” Mr. Ramesh asked.

The Congress said the Income Tax Act provides tax benefits on donations to registered political parties. These provisions were being misused through the RUPPs, it said.

Mr. Gohil said the government should investigate the parties and the people who donated to them. Under the Income Tax Act, a penalty of 200% can be

imposed on those found guilty, and criminal proceedings initiated against individuals and chartered accountants involved in wrongdoing, he said.

He also demanded that the licences of chartered accountants found guilty be cancelled and that criminal cases be filed against those running the alleged bogus political parties.

Public disclosure

The Congress further sought public disclosure of details of donations received by bogus political parties, as well as information on those people linked to the parties who later joined the BJP.

Mr. Gohil alleged that no action had been taken against even one person despite the alleged tax evasion exceeding ₹10,000 crore. “Officials had recommended action against those involved but that orders had not come from the “top”, he added.

He also questioned the Election Commission’s role in scrutinising the funding.

Rahul’s ‘Goonj’ impact won’t extend beyond Congress workers: Nabin

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Bharatiya Janata Party president Nitin Nabin on Wednesday targeted Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi over his “*Chhatron ki Goonj*” programme series, claiming that its impact would not extend beyond his party workers.

“Those who are trying to misdirect the voices of children...if there had been strength in their own voices, when they had the opportunity, they would have done something for the youth of this country,” said Mr. Nabin in response to a



Nitin Nabin

question at a press conference.

He said: “Under the leadership of Narendra Modi, today’s youth is moving forward by becoming self-reliant.”

Attacking the Congress over its recent decision to

sing only two stanzas of *Vande Mataram* at party events, Mr. Nabin described the party as having an “anarchic” and “anti-national” mindset.

October 7 will mark 25 years since Mr. Modi began his public-service career as Gujarat Chief Minister. Mr. Nabin said the party was therefore holding a month-long “*Seva Sankalp Abhiyan*” from September 17 to October 17.

The campaign’s purpose was to take to every person the changes brought by him during this period, ranging from good governance and welfare schemes, to strengthening

the resolve of “*Viksit Bharat 2047*”, he said.

Listing the achievements of the Modi government, he said 25 crore poor families were lifted out of poverty; 80 crore people provided ration; over 100 crore connected to social security schemes; 200 crore free COVID vaccines administered; houses given to over four crore poor people, etc.

He said the BJP’s campaigns were not responses to Opposition programmes. They were based on the party’s ideology, vision, and manifesto, and with the goal to unite the country’s citizens.

In Rahul case, CJI says all parties are treated equally

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Chief Justice of India Surya Kant on Wednesday said that “all parties are treated equally” in the Supreme Court after senior advocate and BJP spokesperson Gaurav Bhatia, appearing for a complainant in a defamation case against Congress leader Rahul Gandhi, alleged that the Opposition leader’s matter is being repeatedly adjourned.

The exchange happened during an oral mentioning by Mr. Bhatia to tag Mr. Gandhi’s plea against criminal proceedings arising from his al-

leged remarks concerning the Army and the Chinese attack in the context of the 2020 Galwan clash.

He said the last time the case was listed was in December last year. The top court had scheduled the next hearing on April 22, 2026. However, the case had not been listed until September 9.

Mr. Bhatia alleged the case was not being listed due to the “person mentioned”, and he should not be treated like a “VVIP”.

He said Mr. Gandhi’s side was indulging in “dilatatory tactics” to avoid a hearing.

Advocate Prasanna S.,

for Mr. Gandhi, vehemently objected to the submissions made by Mr. Bhatia, saying that such statements should not be permitted to be made in court.

“All parties are treated equally here,” Chief Justice Kant addressed Mr. Bhatia.

The Bench advised Mr. Bhatia to submit an application for de-tagging of the case.

The court had earlier stayed proceedings against Mr. Gandhi in the case based on a complaint filed by a retired Border Roads Organisation (BRO) officer, Uday Shankar Shrivastava, before a Lucknow Magistrate court in August 2023.

Withdraw stand on Gram Sabha consent, rights group urges Ministry

Abhinav Lakshman
NEW DELHI

The Tribal Affairs Ministry must immediately withdraw its August 31 office memorandum that claimed there was “no provision” under the Forest Rights Act (FRA) to seek consent of Gram Sabhas for diverting forest land for non-forest purposes, the Campaign for Survival and Dignity (CSD) said in a statement on Wednesday.

The national platform of Adivasi and forest-dweller organisations said the Ministry “cannot simply wash its hands of its responsibility”, calling the Ministry’s position “factually and legally untenable”, which “smacks of dereliction of duty”.

“It is completely shocking that the Ministry of Tribal Affairs has made such a gargantuan factual blunder, something which could have been avoided simply by reading the text of the law,” said the CSD.

The statement comes amid criticisms of the Ministry’s communication to the Power Ministry, with which it is currently in discussions about how the requirement of 100% Gram Sabha consent for diversion of forest land has become a “critical bottleneck” delaying large government projects, as first reported by *The Hindu*. Congress leader Jairam Ramesh had also criticised the position of the Ministry as a “shocking stance”.

BJD stages protest over Mines and Minerals Amendment Act

Satvasundar Barik
BHUBANESWAR

The Biju Janata Dal staged a massive protest demonstration demanding constitutional intervention for the reversal of the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) (MMDR) Amendment Act, 2026 here on Wednesday.

BJD leaders marched towards the Lok Bhavan to apprise Governor Hari Babu Kambhampati of the consequences for Odisha upon the implementation of the Act. They submitted a comprehensive memorandum addressed to President Droupadi Murmu



Seeking action: Police stopping BJD workers during a protest against the MMDR Amendment Act 2026 in Bhubaneswar. PTI

through the Governor.

“Any legislative measure that substantially curtails the rights and financial interests of the State in relation to mines and mineral-

bearing lands therefore has far-reaching consequences for Odisha and its people, and deserves careful constitutional and legal examination,” the BJD said.

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann on Wednesday asked the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi not to “do politics over dead bodies” after the Congress leader stepped up his attack on the Aam Aadmi Party government over the alleged death by suicide of a Dalit man, Gulzar Singh.

Mr. Gandhi demanded the resignation of Punjab Finance Minister Harpal Singh Cheema and an independent probe into the death, alleging that Gulzar had been pressured and

Congress claims man died by suicide after being humiliated for questioning Minister about drug menace

humiliated after he had questioned the Minister about the drug menace in his area.

“A dangerous pattern is emerging under Punjab’s AAP government – if you question government’s failures, the response will come in the form of threats and torture,” Mr. Gandhi said in a post on X.

He alleged that Mr. Singh, whose son had fal-

len victim to drugs, had questioned Mr. Cheema about the government’s failure to stop the drug trade and was subsequently pressured to apologise.

“The government’s job is to answer to the people, not to ‘crush’ those who ask questions,” he said.

Mann’s response

Responding to Mr. Gandhi, Mr. Mann said: “Rahul Gandhiji, don’t do politics over dead bodies; Punjabis do not like this kind of politics.”

The Chief Minister said the police had already arrested the accused and alleged that Congress lead-

**OREDA LIMITED**
(Formerly known as Odisha Renewable Energy Development Agency)
(Under Department of Energy, Government of Odisha)
CIN : U35105OD2024SGC045786

Notice No : 3250 / OREDA Ltd.
PD-140/2026

Date : 05/09/2026

Request for Empanelment of Original Equipment Manufacturers (OEMs) for Solar PV System Components and Discovery of Indicative Supply & Transportation Rates for Renewable Energy Projects under OREDA LTD.

1. Date of publication of RFE on E-procurement website and OREDA website	05.09.2026
2. Due date of pre-bid query submission as per format of NIT	09.09.2026, Time : 5:00 PM
3. Due date and time for submission of online copy of Technical Bid	21.09.2026, Time : 5:00 PM
4. Due date and time for submission of hard copies of Technical Bid for select Bid Forms only.	24.09.2026, Time : 5:00 PM
5. Tentative date and time for the opening of Technical Bid for both online copies and hard copies	25.09.2026, Time : 3:00 PM

Details can be seen from the website www.tenderwizard.com/OREDA or www.oredaorissa.com. Further corrigendum, if any, will be uploaded in these websites only.

Sd/-
Chief Executive Officer
28001/24/2627
OIPR-28001/28005/1/26-27/0006

**GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA, “e”.-PROCUREMENT NOTICE**
WORKS DEPARTMENT
E-mail : ceworldbankprojects@gmail.com

Bid Identification No. CE-Bridges-I - 12 / 2026-27

- The Chief Engineer (Bridges-I), Odisha on behalf of Governor of Odisha invites percentage rate bid in double cover system in ONLINE MODE from eligible contractors for construction of Road / Bridge work as detailed below :
- Nature of Work : Road works
- No. of work : 02 nos.
- Tender Paper Cost : Rs.10,000.00 (On-line)
- Class of Contractor : A / Special Class Contractor
- Available of bid document : From 10.00 AM of 10.09.2026 to 5.00 PM of 29.09.2026
- Date of opening of Bid : Dt.30.09.2026 at 11.30 AM
- The Bidders have to participate in ONLINE bidding only. Further details can be seen from the website : <https://tenderodisha.gov.in> . Any Addendum / Corrigendum / Cancellation will be hosted in the website only.

Chief Engineer, (Bridges-I), Odisha, Bhubaneswar.
OFFICE OF THE ENGINEER-IN-CHIEF (CIVIL), ODISHA, BHUBANESWAR
34001/767/2627
OIPR-34001/34174/1/26-27/0021

**Dr. B.R. AMBEDKAR UNIVERSITY DELHI**
(Established by the Act of Legislative Assembly of National Capital Territory of Delhi)

RECRUITMENT NOTICE FOR TEACHING POSTS
(NOTICE REGARDING EXTENSION OF LAST DATES TO APPLY)

No. AUD/55-1(67)/Rect./2026/929
Dr. B. R. Ambedkar University Delhi, a State University established through an Act by the Legislature of the National Capital Territory of Delhi, invited online applications from the eligible candidates for the faculty positions (Professor, Associate Professor and Assistant Professor) on regular basis vide Advertisement No. AUD/55-1(67)/Rect./2026/838 dated 31.07.2026. In continuation of the same the last date to apply online and submit application in hard copy form are being extended as follows:

- Last date to apply online: 19.09.2026 (up to 23:59 hrs)
- Last date of receiving applications in hard copy form: 28.09.2026 (up to 17:30 hrs)

For Qualifications, Eligibility Criteria, General Instructions, Online Application Form, Payment of Fee & other details, please visit University website: <https://aud.delhi.gov.in>

Lothian Road, Kashmere Gate, Delhi – 110 006, Email: careers@aud.ac.in
DIP/Shabdarth/Classified/0205/26-27

REGISTRAR

Directorate of Higher Education, Govt. of NCT of Delhi

Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers (GRSE) on Wednesday launched *Sagar Manthan*, an indigenous ocean research vessel being built for the National Centre for Polar and Ocean Research (NCPOR), in a major boost to India's capabilities in deep-sea exploration and scientific research. A top government official said the ₹840-crore research vessel is expected to be ready for use by early 2028. Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Earth Sciences Jitendra Singh congratulated GRSE and the Ministry of Earth Sciences on the launch and naming of the vessel and conveyed his wishes on the occasion. ^{PTI}

The Aam Aadmi Party's (AAP) national council on Wednesday re-elected Arvind Kejriwal as the party's national convener, the highest post in the party, a statement said. The party's 15th national council meeting was held on Wednesday under Mr. Kejriwal's chairmanship and a total of 330 members participated in the meeting. "During the meeting, a new 23-member national executive was constituted. Arvind Kejriwal has once again been unanimously elected as the AAP's national convener. Pankaj Gupta has been elected as the national secretary, while N. D. Gupta will continue as the national treasurer," the statement said.

Vice-President C.P. Radhakrishnan on Wednesday underlined Arunachal Pradesh's strategic importance to India and said the State was an integral part of the country's unity. Addressing a special session of the State's 60-member Assembly, he said the northeastern State plays a vital role in safeguarding India's borders. Mr. Radhakrishnan also highlighted the nation's diversity. The Vice-President's statement comes as New Delhi flagged "anomalies" in the United Nations' new world map depicting Arunachal Pradesh and Aksai Chin, two integral parts of India, as separate regions positioned between the borders claimed by India and China.

A probe into the alleged terror offences involving six Ukrainian citizens and one U.S. national, who were arrested by the National Investigation Agency (NIA) in March on charges of training anti-India armed groups in Myanmar, continues to look into whether they were engaged in activities prejudicial to India's security, government sources said. As per the NIA, the accused persons provided training in drone assembly and operation, drone warfare and jamming technology to members of Myanmar-based ethnic armed groups, including the Chin National Front (CNF) and the Kachin Independence Army (KIA).

A CH-CHE

NO WORRIES

Shafali backs India's middle-order to come good in the semifinal



X@BCCIWOMEN

India opener Shafali Verma on Wednesday backed the team's middle-order to come good in the Asia Cup semifinal against Bangladesh. "I'd say there have been some bad days. But they are all very good batters. And just talking about Bharti (Fulmali) and Richa (Ghosh), they are very good finishers and doing great things".

NEW RECORD

Kishan surpasses Karthik for most runs in a Duleep Trophy final



R. RAGU

East Zone skipper Ishan Kishan, /left, broke the record for most runs by a batter in a Duleep Trophy final. The Jharkhand southpaw scored 350 runs in the ongoing title-decider against South Zone (270 & 80), surpassing Dinesh Karthik's tally of 333 (183 & 150) achieved against West Zone in the 2010 final.

FIRST LOVE

I thought I would play Tests before white-ball cricket: Tilak



R. RAGU

I always tell everyone I want to play red-ball cricket for India. That's my biggest goal because I really love playing red-ball cricket. As a kid, I thought I'd play Test cricket first and then white-ball cricket. I'm really keen to play red-ball cricket, and... let's see how it goes — Tilak Varma.

BLISTERING START

Hermann only second batter to score 150 on ODI debut



X@PROTEASMENCSA

South Africa opener Jordan Hermann smashed a sensational 150 off just 126 balls against Namibia in Windhoek, equalling the record for the highest score by a batter on ODI debut. He matched the mark set by teammate Matthew Breetzke, who also scored 150 on his maiden ODI appearance last year.



Dominant: Harmanpreet & Co. have momentum on their side. X@BCCIWOMEN

India will look to move closer to eighth title

ASIA CUP

Press Trust of India DUBAI

India will start as the overwhelming favourite when it faces a gritty Bangladesh side in the first semifinal of the women's Asia Cup on Thursday. The Harmanpreet Kaur-led team has been in imperious form in the continental tournament so far, topping Group A after winning all its matches. The seven-time champion's campaign has been highlighted by dominant displays, none more so than the thrashing of Pakistan, which it skittled out for just 55 before romping to a seven-wicket victory. The batting unit wears a formidable look. Smriti Mandhana enters the crucial fixture riding high on confidence after her exploits in the first round, including the century against Hong Kong. Shafali Verma, who recently became the

youngest and fastest to cross the 3,000-run milestone in women's T20Is, has put the rival attacks on the back foot in the PowerPlay. The middle-order, anchored by Harmanpreet and Richa Ghosh, offers both stability and firepower. On the bowling front, India possesses immense variety and depth. Deepti Sharma, having etched her name in the record books as the leading wicket-taker in women's T20Is, continues to spin a web around opposition batters alongside Shree Charani. In contrast, Bangladesh's path to the final-four stage required resilience. Nigar Sultana's side secured its semifinal berth with a 34-run win over the UAE, though its batting frailties were exposed when it slumped to 55 for six. For Bangladesh to pose a challenge, its top-order must fire against a probing Indian bowling pack.

Match starts at 8 p.m. IST.

East does not give South an inch, coronation all but a matter of time

Despite getting a 372-run first-innings lead, Kishan opts to bat the opposition out of the game; the visitor reaches 212 for five in its second essay, ahead by 584 runs at the end of day four; Kushagra and Quraishi will look to frustrate the host further

DULEEP TROPHY FINAL

S. Dipak Ragav CHENNAI

A five-day First Class match in India — usually reserved for knockout fixtures — is designed to give teams a chance to push for an outright result. At the same time, it tends to produce oddities because the focus is on securing the first-innings lead, which is enough to claim victory. Once that is achieved, the contest often fizzles out. Yet the teams still have to go through the motions until at least tea on the final day, even if the outcome is a foregone conclusion. The 2026 Duleep Trophy final between South Zone and East Zone, in all likelihood, will go down in history as one such game after the latter secured the crucial first-innings lead on the fourth day at the MAC Stadium here. South, resuming at 242 for six in pursuit of East's massive 708, was bundled out for 336 at lunch on Wednesday. Realistically, South's best hope was to delay the inevitable, and that relied



The highlights: While Tilak's gritty effort ended one short of a century, Kishan smashed a flamboyant 80 in the second innings. R. RAGU



on Tilak Varma getting a big one. For the first two hours of the penultimate day, the left-hander did just that, positively countering Mohammed Shami and Mukesh Kumar's burst with the second new ball. C.V. Milind supported his captain, with the duo adding 78 for the seventh wicket. But once Shikhar Mohan had Milind caught at short-leg, the end was near. Tilak, in a rush to get to his landmark, fell ago-

nisingly short by one run while trying to push for a single, only to give a simple return catch to off-spinner Kounain Quraishi. Despite a 372-run lead, Ishan Kishan opted to bat the opposition out of the game and, at stumps, East was 212 for five in its second innings, ahead by 584 runs. Though the contest was virtually sealed, a healthy crowd had gathered in the hope of seeing Vaibhav

Sooryavanshi put on a show. The southpaw, though, perished early, stumped while attempting to charge down off-spinner T. Vijay. Kishan — who smashed 270 in the first essay — continued from where he left off, stroking his way to a flamboyant 80 (98b, 9x4, 3x6). He was severe on spinners Vijay and Shreyas Gopal, repeatedly stepping down at every opportunity and carting them all over

the park to entertain the fans.

The scores: East Zone — 1st innings: 708 in 163 overs. **South Zone — 1st innings:** Ricky Bhui c Kushagra b Mukesh 1, N. Jagadeesan c Abhimanyu b Shikhar 32, Devdutt Padikkal c sub (Denish) b Mukesh 62, Shaik Rasheed lbw b Shami 27, Tilak Varma c & b Quraishi 99, R. Smaran c Kushagra b Shami 23, Shreyas Gopal c & b Quraishi 26, C.V. Milind c Gharami b Shikhar 43, T. Vijay run out 1, Mohammed Siraj lbw b Mukesh 1, M.D. Nidheesh (not out) 0; Extras (b-10, lb-4, nb-4, w-3): 21; Total (in 107.3 overs): 336. **Fall of wickets:** 1-10, 2-70, 3-126, 4-129, 5-174, 6-240, 7-318, 8-322, 9-336. **East Zone bowling:** Shami 16-5-42-2, Mukesh 19-1-62-3, Quraishi 39.3-8-99-2, Abhijit 8-0-34-0, Shikhar 20-0-67-2, Sooryavanshi 4-0-10-0, Kishan 1-0-8-0. **East Zone — 2nd innings:** Vaibhav Sooryavanshi st. Jagadeesan b Vijay 8, Abhimanyu Easwaran c Padikkal b Siraj 3, Shikhar Mohan lbw b Rasheed 52, Ishan Kishan c Padikkal b Nidheesh 80, Kumar Kushagra (batting) 34, Sudip Kumar Gharami run out 2, Md Kounain Quraishi (batting) 26; Extras: (b-7): 7; Total (for five wkts. in 51 overs): 212. **Fall of wickets:** 1-13, 2-13, 3-139, 4-154, 5-160. **South Zone bowling:** Siraj 7-2-17-1, Vijay 17-1-84-1, Shreyas 12-1-57-0, Nidheesh 5-1-14-1, Rasheed 7-1-20-1, Bhui 3-0-13-0.

'I was focused on what the team needed'

S. Dipak Ragav CHENNAI

Skipper Tilak Varma has been the standout player for South Zone in the Duleep Trophy this year. The Hyderabad batter was instrumental in taking the team to the final, leading from the front with unbeaten knocks of 116 and 51 in the semifinal against North. In the summit clash, Tilak yet again stood tall, scoring a valiant 99 against East Zone at the MAC Stadium, even if he couldn't help his team avoid conceding a huge lead. "It's an important knock, but at the same time I was only focused on what the team needed. I could have taken more chances before, but the plan was simply to take it session by session," said Tilak on Wednesday. "If some other batter stayed with me, I was confident we [could] have batted through to the end of the day, [and] take it session-by-session till tomorrow [Thursday] and push for a draw. Unfortunately, we lost wickets, and the result went in their favour," he added. **Nice reward** "A hundred would have been a nice reward for the hard yards I put in the heat, but individual milestones don't matter as much as the result".



Shakeel... no answer. AFP

Pakistan's batting again capitulates

Agence France-Presse BIRMINGHAM

Pakistan slumped to 133 all out on the opening day of the third Test at Edgbaston on Wednesday after the latest in a series of woeful batting displays that have marred its tour of England. Pakistan fielded three debutants among four changes to the side. Pakistan's batters had few answers to Ollie Robinson (three for 15), Jofra Archer (three for 25) and Josh Tongue (four for 42) as they got bowled out in 33.5 overs. The visitors made early inroads into England's batting before Emilio Gay (60) and Harry Brook (52 batting) took the host to 156 for four at stumps. **The scores:** Pakistan 133 in 33.5 overs (Shakeel 43, Tongue 4/42) vs. England 156/4 in 39 overs (Gay 60, Brook 52 batting). **Toss:** England.

Shelton dethrones Alcaraz in a thriller

US OPEN

Agence France-Presse NEW YORK

Carlos Alcaraz tumbled out of the US Open quarterfinals at 3.34 a.m. on Wednesday, falling to American Ben Shelton in an epic five-set thriller that broke the record for latest finish ever at Flushing Meadows. The big-hitting Shelton claimed his first career win over Alcaraz, 6-7(5), 6-1, 6-3, 1-6, 7-6 (10-7), ending the Spaniard's hopes of retaining his title in his first tournament back after a four-month injury absence. It took a brutal four hours and 28 minutes, finishing long past the previous latest finish in New York of 2.50 a.m. — Alcaraz's five-set quarterfinal win over Jannik Sinner in 2022. Shelton matched his semifinal run at the US Open three years ago and booked an all-American last-four match against Frances Tiafoe, who came back from two sets down to beat Alex Michelsen 5-7, 3-6, 7-5, 6-3, 7-6 (10-6). It means Tiafoe and Shelton have a chance to become the first Americans to win the US Open men's singles title since An-

THE RESULTS

Quarterfinals: Men: 11-Tiafoe (USA) bt Michelsen (USA) 5-7, 3-6, 7-5, 6-3, 7-6 [10-6]; 8-Shelton (USA) bt 2-Alcaraz (Esp) 6-7(5), 6-1, 6-3, 1-6, 7-6 [10-7]. **Women:** 2-Rybakina (Kaz) bt Zheng (Chn) 3-6, 6-1, 6-4; 3-Pegula (USA) bt 26-Navarro (USA) 3-6, 6-4, 6-3. **Junior girls: Second round:** Arina Malygina bt Maaya Rajeshwaran 6-3, 5-7, 7-5.

dy Roddick in 2003. Alcaraz had gone from strength to strength through his first four matches, but Shelton finally proved too much. Shelton, pumped up by the Arthur Ashe Stadium crowd, reeled off nine straight games bridging the second and third sets to seize control, capitalising on Alcaraz's flagging serve and getting the better of him in rallies that left him winded. **Rybakina is No. 1** In women's singles, Elena Rybakina outlasted China's Qinwen Zheng 3-6, 6-1, 6-4 to reach the semifinals and ensure the World No. 1 ranking. Earlier, third-seeded Jessica Pegula booked a third straight showdown with top seed Aryna Sabalenka, grinding out a 3-6, 6-4, 6-3 win over American compatriot Emma Navarro.



Taking wing: The big-hitting Shelton held off defending champion Alcaraz in a gruelling five-setter to set up a semifinal against American compatriot Tiafoe. GETTY IMAGES

Pipers put it across Masters, remain in the joint lead

GLOBAL CHESS LEAGUE

P.K. Ajith Kumar BENGALURU

The Bangalore Golf Club is just across the road. That suits Magnus Carlsen fine. He could come to Lalit Ashok, the venue of the Tech Mahindra Global Chess League, after his golfing stint at the course. He spent quite a few hours there on Wednesday, longer than usual, apparently. The fresh air and the green fields seemed to have helped, as he came up with a fine win against Maxime Vachier-Lagrave. It was the World No. 1's second win in the tournament, though he may not have enjoyed his first as much; in the game against Viswanathan Anand, he emerged victorious only because his old World championship rival ran out of time when the position was equal. Carlsen needed no such help from the clock against Vachier-Lagrave. His team, Alpine APL Pipers, won the match against Cheq Mumba Masters 11-6. The highlight of the match was Anish Giri's spectacular victory against M. Pranesh.



Right moves: Giri's defeat of Pranesh was key to Pipers' victory. SUDHAKARA JAIN

The win helped the Pipers retain their joint lead. They have 12 match points, the same as Fyers American Gambits and Ganges Grandmasters. Gambits are more equal at the moment than the others, as they have 60 game points, two more than Pipers. Grandmasters are on 55. Mumba Masters and PBG Alaskan Knights have nine match points each. But it was another dismal day for the two-time champion Triveni Continental Kings, which lost both matches and is lying at the bottom of the table with nine match points. **The results: Alpine APL Pipers bt Cheq Mumba Masters 11-6** (Carlsen bt Vachier-Lagrave; Giri bt

Pranesh; Vidit drew with Mamedyarov; Divya lost to Harika; Humpy drew with Yip; Murzin bt Daneshvar). **Triveni Continental Kings lost to Ganges Grandmasters 3-15** (Firouzja drew with Nepomniachtchi; Wei drew with Aronian; Aravindh drew with Dominguez-Perez; Zhu lost to Shuvalova; Kosteniuk lost to Tsoiakidou; Pranav lost to Mendonca). **Mumba Masters lost to PBG Alaskan Knights 6-11** (Vachier-Lagrave bt Anand; Pranesh drew with Arjun; Mamedyarov drew with Erdogmus; Harika drew with Lagno; Yip lost to Batsiashvili; Daneshvar lost to Abhimanyu). **Fyers American Gambits bt Continental Kings 8-5** (Sindarov bt Firouzja; Nihal drew with Wei; Dubov drew with Aravind; Assaubayeva drew with Zhu; Sarasadat drew with Kosteniuk; Maurizzi drew with Pranav).

Form doesn't really matter when it comes to the World championship battle

The French GM says that the upcoming Olympiad at Samarkand would be an ideal indicator of Gukesh and Sindarov's mindset; feels that the game needs to find a format which is spectator-friendly



INTERVIEW

Maxime Vachier-Lagrave

P.K. Ajith Kumar

Only 15 chess players have touched 2800 Elo points on the FIDE rating list. Arjun Erigaisi was the last to reach there, and it has been two years since. Maxime Vachier-Lagrave crossed the mark in 2016. With a peak rating of 2819, the French Grandmaster is the seventh strongest player in chess history. He is a former World No. 2, and won the World Blitz championship in 2021. MVL, as he is often called, has been playing regularly in India and is now in Bengaluru for the Tech Mahindra Global Chess League. He has played in every single edition of the league. Excerpts from an interview Vachier-Lagrave gave *The Hindu*:

You have played in every season of the Global Chess League.

I think it is really fun. The idea of having people can cheer on at the venue is nice, and you have all the best players in the world. It is also interesting to see the prodigies in the teams and how they go on to make it big later.

You had Javokhir Sindarov as a prodigy, and now he is a challenger for the World Championship match. And we had D. Gukesh (who will play Sindarov in that match) for the first three seasons as well.

It is also a lot of fun to watch these innovations, such as the time control with no increment. And everyone in the team having the same colour for a match is really a nice experience.

Do you like the system of getting more points with black pieces than white?

That is enjoyable. And it is good to



have games that don't last too long and are easy to watch.

And it is better for the television audience, too.

Yeah, that you don't want to be glued for four hours, and sometimes nothing happens for 30 minutes.

How do you find the idea of playing with no increment for the first 40 moves?

When I was a kid, we barely had digital clocks, so it is alright. I still prefer the digital clocks, but we have increment after the 40th move, so it is not as ruthless.

What are your thoughts on the upcoming World championship match between Gukesh and Sindarov?

You never know with matches, how it turns out. At the last World championship, Gukesh was coming in really strong, while Ding Liren looked like he couldn't play chess. Suddenly, you know, Gukesh was under pressure.

It was the same with the previous match, when Ding played against Ian Nepomniachtchi. It looked as if Nepo was winning it. So the form doesn't really matter when it comes to the

World championship match. Yes, Gukesh has been struggling a little bit with his results, but I think he has also been experimenting and, you know, got maybe too much out of his comfort zone.

But in general, when he is playing really well, he is a formidable opponent. I remember having some really good clashes with him. And he had some exceptional performances at the Olympiads.

One thing that I noticed about Gukesh is that, especially ever since he became World champion, it seems like he has to prove a point with every game he plays.

And sometimes that, you know, you cannot have as much energy as that to be there for every game, fighting it out. And, you know, he always takes a lot of risks. And when he is in very good shape, he has a lot of energy, it works out well for him, I think.

But if you get even a slight drop in energy, the consequences can be brutal because his chess requires so much energy and so much confidence as well.

From my point of view, a defining turning point could be the next Olympiad. If Gukesh capitalises on the confidence gained from his performances in his previous two Olympiads, and does a great performance again in this Olympiad

(starting next week at Samarkand), he can go into the World championship in a much better mood.

I think it would be very helpful for him if he gets a little bit of confidence back. He needs some sort of break to be certain that he can play his best chess again.

If he plays like he can, there is simply no favourite in my mind. You have two very strong young players who will be fighting it out.

What makes Sindarov different? He has been brilliant for the last year or so, having won the World Cup and then that absolutely dominant performance to win the Candidates...

He seems to be handling his nerves very well. And of course, his calculation is very good. But like at some point, you know, the difference is some little make or break.

The margins are very narrow, of course, in top level chess. So, it could also be like a very good break.

We will see what happens in the World championship match and before that at the Olympiad as well.

He is an extremely strong player and he is having a very good year. But there are so many good players around.

The Olympiad is coming up right after the Global Chess League and India is the defending champion.

The Indian team is so strong. And we don't know who will be playing on the top board. If France gets to play against them, I will probably be more interested in finding out who is on board one, so that I could prepare.

You will be playing at the pilot event of the newly launched Total World Chess Championship tour.

That is a very exciting event. I am glad that I have managed to qualify, and I hope to make it to the main cycle.

On that tour, the classical bit is

going to be of a duration of 45 minutes and they are calling it fast classical.

I am okay with that. Of course, it matters how I perform individually. But I also care about how chess will evolve as a game and as a spectator sport.

And there is now more money in chess too, especially when you compare with the time you started out.

Yes, chess is on the rise. And I think it is a good opportunity for the game. You have many more players coming into the game. You have many more investors coming too, and trying to get a cut of the action. And I think that is really nice. And we get to experiment a bit.

This is all good for the game. And we need to find out what will be the ideal format for spectators to watch. We also need sometimes the players to evolve a bit and to be ready to give them some of their energy, not only towards the preparation.

As a player, I know preparing for your game is important, but you should also be able to give something back to the game.

R. Praggnanandhaa has been having a great time of late.

I think early last year, he also had some great six, eight months, but then there was a toll of playing so much.

And he had a disappointing Candidates.

But I think he has been working on his stamina and is also able to fight it out always. But we always knew that Pragg was also an exceptionally strong player.

What is next for you after the GCL and the Olympiad?

There is the Total Chess World Championship in Budapest, and then the World rapid and blitz.

How scientists are using menstrual blood in osteoarthritis treatment

Much like saliva or blood plasma, menstrual fluid is rich with biological information; it is packed with immune cells, endometrial tissue, proteins, and genetic fragments; scientists are digging into these biomarkers to find ways to detect diseases early, and drop the use of invasive clinical procedures

Manjeera Gowravaram

For most of history, menstrual blood has been dismissed as biological waste. But emerging research is now recasting this material as a goldmine for non-invasive diagnostics and regenerative medicine. Its potential applications are surprisingly broad, ranging from innovative cervical cancer screenings to advanced cartilage repair.

Much like saliva or blood plasma, menstrual fluid is rich with biological information. It is packed with immune cells, endometrial tissue, proteins, and genetic fragments.

Scientists are now digging into these biomarkers hoping to find ways to detect diseases early, and thus drop the use of invasive clinical procedures.

Stem cells

Researchers have recently reported that they had used menstrual blood to spot cancer early. Normally, medical workers have screened for cervical cancer using clinical check-ups that many people skip due to discomfort, cost, limited access to healthcare, and in fact plain embarrassment. As a result, screening rates remain low even in economically developed regions.

In 2025, a large population-based study in *The BMJ* by researchers from China offered a workaround. The team found that menstrual blood collected directly from sanitary pads could be tested for human papillomavirus DNA and precancerous lesions just as accurately as cervical swab samples collected by a clinician. Of course, the method excludes those who do not menstruate, but the fact that it offered a non-invasive, inexpensive, and suitable test that could begin from home is notable.

Menstrual blood is also gaining research focus thanks to stem cells derived from it. The groundwork for this was laid back in 2007 when a team from the U.S. and Canada successfully isolated menstrual stem cells from menstrual blood. These cells came from the endometrium, the uterine lining that breaks down and rebuilds itself on a monthly cycle without scarring – something other human tissue cannot do. The researchers believed the stem cells had something to do with that ability. In the lab, the menstrual-blood-derived stem cells readily divided and proved to be tough and versatile.

Researchers are already using them to grow uterine organoids – small functional models of the uterus located outside the body and used to study conditions like endometriosis. The stem cells could reveal traces of exposure to chemical compounds like phthalates and parabens, which was previously not possible to discern without an invasive examination.

Indeed, while bone marrow stem cells are still the gold standard for many therapies, extracting them is a gruelling process. It is painful, requires anaesthesia, and bears significant surgical risks. Menstrual-blood-derived stem cells however can be collected non-invasively, and sans the ethical baggage that often complicates stem-cell sourcing.

As the science of these cells has matured, so have their applications. For instance, in 2025, a team in China studied



While most current treatments for osteoarthritis mask the pain, new findings suggest a way to actually slow or reverse the damage. GETTY IMAGES/STOCKPHOTO

the role they could play on Niemann-Pick disease type CI. This is a rare and devastating inherited condition that is caused by cholesterol and lipids build-up inside cells, leading to rapid neurological decline, loss of motor function, and dementia. The study found that menstrual-blood-derived stem cells could significantly lower neuroinflammation and cell death in experimental models of the disease. The work is still in its early stages, but for a condition whose therapeutic options are currently limited to drugs easing the clinical symptoms, a potential new advance is welcome.

A 2023 study by Iranian researchers showed that when these cells were delivered alongside their conditioned medium – the nutrient-rich fluid they had been cultured with – they helped accelerate heart recovery in rat models after a heart attack.

In hepatology, menstrual-blood-derived stem cells have been found to suppress the specific liver cells responsible for scarring and fibrosis. Because they naturally migrate towards areas of inflammation and cancer, researchers are also exploring engineering these cells to deliver therapeutic genes directly to a tumour site, sparing the rest of the body from the toxic side effects of chemotherapy.

Many experts increasingly believe extracellular vesicles (EVs) are the future of regenerative medicine. They are easier to standardise than whole stem cells – which are complete, living biological units that can divide and adapt within the body,

but vary significantly from one batch to another. They also carry risks of becoming unintended tissue types. Because EVs are not whole cells, but rather clumps of proteins, lipids, RNA, and signalling molecules enclosed by membranes secreted from the parent cell, they can't divide or differentiate into other tissues. This makes them safer, more stable alternatives and less likely to trigger immune rejection, can be engineered to evade immune detection, and can be frozen and stored just like conventional biological drugs.

Menstrual-blood-derived stem cells can be made to release these EVs when cultured in specific conditions in the lab, such as hypoxia (low oxygen) or by adding inflammatory cytokines.

Ordinary challenges

In a notable study published in *Scientific Reports* in February, a team from Lithuania isolated EVs from healthy donors and introduced them to human cartilage cells taken from patients who had undergone joint surgery. Within hours, the cartilage cells had absorbed the EVs and produced a new extracellular matrix, the scaffolding of healthy joints. When the team simulated joint inflammation, the vesicles reduced the release of markers associated with cartilage degradation.

Since osteoarthritis disproportionately affects women, the researchers also tracked hormone receptors. Specifically, when they examined how EVs affected receptors in the joint tissue, they found

that the EVs had increased the expression of the progesterone receptor in cartilage cells, potentially restoring a hormonal signalling pathway that tends to deteriorate in women following menopause.

While most current treatments for osteoarthritis mask the pain, these findings suggest a way to actually slow or reverse the damage. Even though the research is nascent, if the findings hold up in future trials, any benefits will matter considering the number of people living with this condition, estimated to be 595 million worldwide in 2020.

Some significant hurdles remain as well. Scientists do not yet know how long these cells will survive once they are introduced into the body. There is no long-term human safety data – partly because there are no reliable markers to track the cells once they are inside a patient. Producing consistent, high-quality batches also remains a challenge, since no standardised benchmarks exist to verify the cells before use. The cells must themselves behave differently depending on the donor, varying with age, hormonal status, contraceptive history, and the conditions in which the cells were grown in the lab.

Then again, these are ordinary challenges of early-stage biomedical research rather than reasons to dismiss what has already been found.

(Manjeera Gowravaram has a PhD in RNA biochemistry and works as a freelance science writer. gmanjeera@gmail.com)



A view of a planetary nebula. The study focused on two extremely dense types of stellar objects – millisecond pulsars and white dwarfs. NASA

Dark matter could form tiny black holes inside stars: study

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

Dark matter, the unseen substance that makes up most of the universe's matter, could play a more dramatic role than previously thought.

A new study suggests that heavy dark matter particles trapped inside a dense star could accumulate at its core, collapse into a tiny black hole roughly the mass of a loaded semi-truck, and gradually transform the entire star into a black hole.

The authors of the study, published in the latest issue of the *Physical Review D*, are H.A. Adarsha and Chandrachur Chakraborty of the Manipal Centre for Natural Sciences at Manipal Academy of Higher Education, and Sudip Bhattacharyya of Mumbai's Tata Institute of Fundamental Research (TIFR).

Two stellar objects

Their study focuses on two extremely dense types of stellar objects – millisecond pulsars and white dwarfs.

An extremely dense star is essentially a dead star that has run out of nuclear fuel. A millisecond pulsar is a rapidly rotating neutron star that emits regular beams of electromagnetic radiation at intervals of less than 10 milliseconds, while a white

A new study suggests that heavy dark matter particles trapped inside a dense star could accumulate at its core, collapse into a tiny black hole roughly the mass of a loaded semi-truck, and gradually transform the entire star into a black hole

dwarf is a hot, dense stellar remnant.

A black hole would evaporate rapidly if left on its own, but the researchers' calculations through a new mathematical framework showed that a continuous supply of dark matter could keep such tiny black holes growing inside dense stars.

The researchers used a conservative age of about 1 billion years for millisecond pulsars and about 10 billion years for white dwarfs to place limits on the possible properties of ultra-heavy dark matter.

“Hawking radiation causes black holes to lose mass, with smaller black holes evaporating faster. However, some hypothetical ultra-heavy dark matter particles could be captured by dense stellar remnants such as millisecond pulsars and white dwarfs, collect at their centres, and eventually collapse into a tiny black hole,” the researchers said.

Consumption of dark matter

They calculated what would happen next by considering a black hole's consumption of stellar material, continued feeding by dark matter, Hawking evaporation, and quantum effects important at extremely small scales.

“We find that continued dark matter feeding can allow black holes born with masses as low as about 40 tonnes to overcome evaporation and eventually consume their host stars. Because many millisecond pulsars and white dwarfs have survived for billions of years, dark matter capable of destroying them sooner can be ruled out,” the study said.

“These ancient stars, therefore, provide natural laboratories for probing forms of ultra-heavy dark matter that are difficult to test on earth,” they found.

THE SCIENCE QUIZ

Following the deadly glacial collapse in Nepal, a quiz on glaciers

Radhika Santhanam

QUESTION 1

During the Pleistocene Ice Age, the geological time period that includes the last ice age, glaciers covered almost one-third of all the land. Today, in which continent is the vast majority of the world's glacial ice found?

QUESTION 2

During the Last Glacial Maximum, roughly 29,000 to 19,000 years ago, when temperatures were extremely low and woolly mammoths and saber-toothed cats roamed the earth, this continent had some glaciers. Today, however, given its low mountains and warm, dry climate, it has none. Name this continent, the only one in the world without glaciers.

QUESTION 3

Located in the Karakoram range,

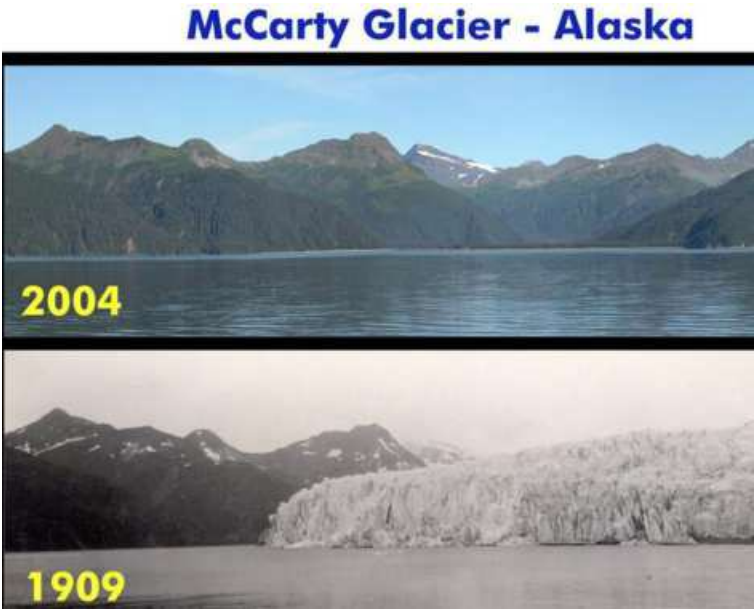
the second-highest mountain range on the earth, this glacier is one of the longest and highest outside the polar regions. It is also known as the site of the highest-altitude battlefield in the world and has a large and permanent military presence on or near it. Its name means 'place of roses'. Name it.

QUESTION 4

Nearly 70% of the world's X is locked away in glaciers and ice sheets. What is X, essential for agriculture, industry, and domestic needs? Be specific.

QUESTION 5

Outside the polar regions, this country has the most glaciers: over 7,000. It is also the world's largest importer of tea, contains the world's highest polo ground, and has one of the highest shares of mountain terrain in South Asia. Name the country.



Visual: The image shows Alaska's McCarty Glacier in Kenai Fjords National Park. In under a century, the glacier receded by about 15 km. There is dense vegetation on the slopes, once covered by ice. What is the phenomenon illustrated in this image called? PUBLIC DOMAIN

Answers to September 3 quiz:

- Effective mood stabiliser whose mechanism of action is unclear – **Ans: Lithium**
- Immobility-inducing substance whose molecular effects are unclear – **Ans: Anaesthesia**
- Compounds, some of which exhibit a mystery form of superconductivity – **Ans: Cuprates**
- First-line drug used to treat type-II diabetes – **Ans: Metformin**
- Drug from phencyclidine that can lift depression in hours – **Ans: Ketamine**

Visual: **Turbulence**

First contact:
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For feedback and suggestions for 'Science', please write to **science@thehindu.co.in** with the subject 'Daily page'

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Heatwave days recorded by Spain across June-August

61 Mainland Spain endured its hottest summer since records began in 1961, with an unprecedented 61 heatwave days across June, July and August, the national weather agency AEMET said. The average temperature for those three months was 24.5C, 0.3C above the previous record from 2025 and 2.4C higher than the 1991-2020 reference period, AEMET said. AFP

Death toll in Yemen prison airstrike earlier this week

23 Rescuers dug through the rubble of a Houthi-run prison that was hit in an airstrike in northern Yemen earlier this week, even as the Saudi-led coalition renewed its attacks on Wednesday. Rescuers recovered four bodies, raising the death toll at the prison to 23 people. The flare-up was a major escalation in renewed fighting between a U.S. ally and the Iranian proxy group. AP

Death toll from measles outbreak in Bangladesh

1,002 The death toll from a measles outbreak in Bangladesh has topped 1,000 children since March, health officials said, admitting failures in a vaccination drive. The South Asian nation of 170 million has recorded 1,002 deaths and 187,484 infections among children, according to the Directorate General of Health Services. AFP

Worth of Google's AI expansion proposal in Finland

13 in € billion. Google will invest at least €13 billion in data centres and other digital infrastructure to power its AI ambitions in Finland, in what the U.S. tech giant called its biggest single investment in Europe. The plan also calls for clean energy projects over the next two years, which Google said was “a testament to Finland’s leadership in responsibly building AI infrastructure”. AFP

Amount approved by Chhattisgarh Cabinet for the startup mission

500 in ₹ crore. The Chhattisgarh Cabinet on Wednesday approved a ₹500 crore startup and skills mission aimed at creating new opportunities for employment, skill development, entrepreneurship and innovation for the youth of the State, officials said. PTI
COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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Did OpenAI solve Navier-Stokes problem?

OpenAI's claim of Navier-Stokes breakthrough has sparked controversy after Tristan Buckmaster alleged that its internal model arrived at the exact approach he and Levent Alpöge had been pursuing; questions remain over whether OpenAI trained on private Codex data, the proof's validity and who deserves credit

FULL CONTEXT

Vasudevan Mukunth

The story so far:

In what is quickly becoming an explosive controversy in mathematics, a potential solution to one of the field's greatest open questions has been overshadowed by allegations of espionage and unethical academic conduct. Over the last few days, the mathematical community has been rocked by claims that OpenAI leveraged its enormous computing power – and potentially the private user data of academic researchers – to scoop a solution to the Navier-Stokes equations problem.

What is the Navier-Stokes problem?

The Navier-Stokes equations describe the motion of viscous fluids like water and air, and they have frustrated mathematicians and physicists for more than two centuries.

As OpenAI wrote on its website: “The Navier-Stokes equations use Newton’s second law of motion ($F = m \times a$) to describe how fluids move. Importantly, they treat a fluid as a continuous medium rather than tracking individual molecules. These equations are used for aircraft design, weather forecasting, and the study of blood flow.”

The Clay Mathematics Institute in New York lists a problem about the equations as one of the seven Millennium Prize Problems. That is, anyone who can prove whether the equations always have smooth, predictable solutions or whether the equations can ‘blow up’ – meaning the mathematical solutions reach infinity in finite time – will win \$1 million and considerable prestige in the mathematics community.

What is a forcing function?

The Millennium Prize problem statement, authored by U.S. mathematician Charles Fefferman, offers a few avenues for a valid proof. Options A and B deal with unforced equations, while Options C and D allow for a solution that includes an external forcing function.

A forcing function is an external influence that adds momentum to the fluid, e.g., you dip your spoon into a bowl of water and stir it. A forced blow-up would be when you keep stirring the fluid harder and harder until the equations predict the flow becomes infinitely violent in a finite amount of time – as if you were stirring at nearly the speed of light.

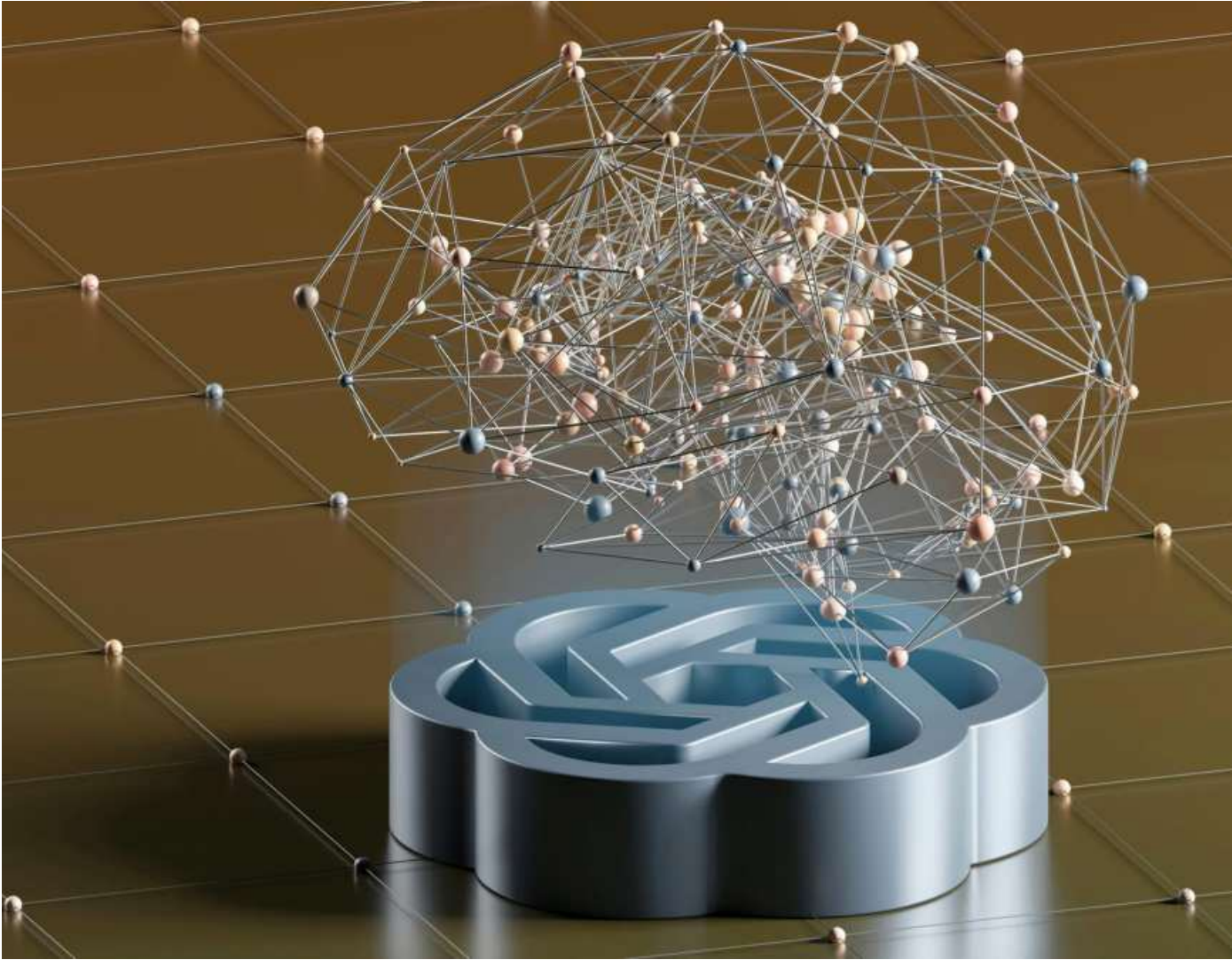
For such a blow-up to qualify for the Millennium Prize under Options C and D, the force causing the blow-up can’t suddenly appear/disappear or change abruptly from one place or time to another. It must obey the usual laws of physics.

Over the last year, New York University mathematician Tristan Buckmaster and Anthropic researcher Levent Alpöge have been using AI models to use a technique developed by Spanish mathematicians Diego Córdoba and Luis Martínez-Zoróa to show that forced blow-ups cause the Navier-Stokes equations to become insensible in finite time.

This route is a niche vector of attack; mathematicians agree it is not possible to arrive at by feeding the problem to an AI chatbot. This detail matters to what followed.

How did OpenAI get involved?

Buckmaster and Alpöge made a breakthrough on August 15. A week later, the duo had their proofs – heavily



While OpenAI has said its agents reached a solution for the Navier-Stokes regularity problem in 88 hours, it is unclear who, if any, outside the company has seen the claimed 100-page proof. GROWTIKA/UNSPLASH

generated by models like Anthropic’s Claude and OpenAI’s GPT-5.6 Sol – checked by a computer to make sure the mathematics were correct.

However, the raw output from the AI was practically unreadable. Buckmaster described one initial proof as “the most horrendous I have ever read”. So Alpöge and Buckmaster spent weeks working around the clock to translate the AI output into a readable paper.

But last week, a rumor began circulating that Anthropic had solved a major open problem in mathematics. On September 3, after hearing OpenAI was investigating the rumors, Buckmaster emailed a prominent mathematician at OpenAI. This information comes from a statement that Buckmaster published on his university webpage.

Buckmaster said he clarified that his work with Alpöge was in a personal capacity and did not represent an institutional effort by Anthropic and that the duo planned to publish its results once it had finished polishing the manuscript. The (unnamed) interlocutor at OpenAI replied expressing excitement.

But on September 4, OpenAI requested a same-day meeting with Buckmaster, which Buckmaster deferred to the following week (i.e., the current week). Two days later, OpenAI urgently requested a meeting, so Buckmaster said he joined a call with OpenAI computer scientist Sebastian Bubeck and another representative. Alpöge did not attend the call.

During this call, Buckmaster said Bubeck dropped a bombshell: an internal OpenAI model had produced a proof of finite-time blow-up for the forced Navier-Stokes equations. When Buckmaster pressed for details, the OpenAI team revealed their solution was exactly “Existence of forced blowup in R3 and T3, with the forcing function is smooth Option C and D in Fefferman” – for Buckmaster, the exact mathematical

route he and Alpöge had been pursuing.

Buckmaster also wrote that he and Alpöge had been logging their work on OpenAI Codex, a tool to translate natural language prompts into code, for months.

At this point, Buckmaster refused to cooperate with OpenAI and rushed to publish his and Alpöge’s results, plus his public statement.

OpenAI subsequently held a press briefing in which it claimed 10,000 AI agents had cracked the problem in an 88-hour marathon that had cost the company millions of dollars.

What is the data-access issue?

Buckmaster’s public statement has already triggered scrutiny of OpenAI’s corporate practices. When it claimed to have solved the same formulation of the problem Buckmaster and Alpöge had been working on, Buckmaster asked how the AI model had arrived there. On the September 6 call, Bubeck allegedly admitted an entire team had been assigned to crack the problem.

Further, Buckmaster said he had been inputting all of his and Alpöge’s drafts into Codex over a year. So when Buckmaster asked if the internal OpenAI model had been trained on or had access to his private Codex sessions, OpenAI said the model “did not look up user data”. But when Buckmaster pressed on whether his data had been used to train the model that worked on the problem, OpenAI didn’t answer.

According to Buckmaster, Bubeck also offered him two unethical proposals. In the first, Buckmaster would post his significant result and OpenAI would post their Navier-Stokes result the following day. The second was that Buckmaster would write a solo paper presenting the Navier-Stokes result and acknowledge the internal OpenAI model.

Bubeck reportedly asserted on the call that he wanted Alpöge removed from authorship because Alpöge is an

employee of Anthropic, OpenAI’s rival.

Buckmaster said he refused both offers and threatened to go public with the conversation, whereupon Bubeck allegedly responded: “Why would you ruin your career?” and “If you don’t want me to be nice, then I don’t have to be nice”.

Bubeck has since publicly called the allegations against him “false and inflammatory”.

What questions remain?

1. Did OpenAI actually solve the problem? While OpenAI has said its agents reached a solution in 88 hours, it is unclear who, if any, outside the company has seen the claimed proof. Since Buckmaster described the AI-generated paper as “slop”, it is also unknown whether OpenAI’s internal model actually produced a rigorous proof or a convoluted approximation.

2. Did OpenAI breach user privacy? The silence regarding whether OpenAI trained its internal model on Buckmaster’s private Codex logs has been deafening.

3. Who deserves the credit? The AI agents? OpenAI the corporation? Buckmaster and Alpöge? Or Diego Córdoba and Luis Martínez-Zoróa? Indeed, Buckmaster wrote in his statement he believes “Luis Martínez-Zoróa deserves a Fields Medal”.

Just before the controversy broke out, Fields Medal winner Terence Tao had published a series of notes about why a ‘human mathematics’ remains relevant in the age of AI. As he wrote: “The point remains that there is a substantial opportunity cost in converting a historically productive and motivating problem ... into a mere viral social media post advertising some benchmark progress, rather than actually advancing the field and developing the next generation of both problems to ask and people to work on them.”

THE GIST

The Navier-Stokes equations describe fluid motion and form one of the seven Millennium Prize Problems, with a \$1 million prize for a valid solution

Buckmaster and Alpöge used AI models to develop a proof of finite-time blow-up involving a forcing function, then worked to turn the AI-generated output into a readable paper

OpenAI later said 10,000 AI agents had solved the problem in an 88-hour effort, while Buckmaster alleged that OpenAI made questionable proposals over publication and authorship

